

Sedbergh & District

LOOKAROUND

Dec 2025/Jan 2026

Donation £1.50

Issue 449

Our last edition for 2025, as usual in full colour. Don't forget the next Lookaround won't be until February.

There's plenty going on in Sedbergh over the Christmas period

and on into the New Year with concerts, Late Night Opening, the Ceildh, and films in the Peoples Hall. Enjoy the festive period, and best wishes to you all. *Ed.*



The poster for the Sedbergh Town Band Christmas Concert features a festive design with a red border. At the top, there are red Christmas baubles and white snowflakes. The title "Sedbergh Town Band Christmas Concert" is written in a bold, serif font. Below the title, there is a row of white houses and Christmas trees. The date and time "Saturday 6th December 2025 6 p.m." are prominently displayed. The location "St Andrew's Church, Sedbergh" is also included. At the bottom, there is a list of activities: "Mulled wine, mince pies & raffle", "Father Christmas", "Christmas jumpers? Oh yes!", "Sing-a-long carols", and "Prizes for the most festive outfits". The ticket information "tickets £8 on the door under 18s free" is also present.

**Sedbergh Town Band
Christmas Concert**

**Saturday 6th December 2025
6 p.m.
St Andrew's Church, Sedbergh**

**tickets £8 on the door
under 18s free**

Mulled wine, mince pies & raffle
Father Christmas
Christmas jumpers? Oh yes!
Sing-a-long carols
Prizes for the most festive outfits

CLOSING DATE: 15th of every month for everything

S & D Lookaround 72 Main Street, Sedbergh LA10 5AD

Mobile: 07464 - 895425

e-mail: editor@sedberghlookaround.org.uk ~ Web Site: <http://www.sedberghlookaround.org.uk>

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Ed Wells

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Weekly Coffee Morning St Andrews Church Every Wednesday 9:30am to 11:30am

Wed 3rd Dec - St John's Garsdale
Wed 10th Dec - St Andrew's
Wed 17th Dec - St Andrew's
Wed 24th & 31st Dec - None

Wed 7th Jan - St Andrew's
Wed 14th Jan- St Andrew's
Wed 21st Jan - St Andrew's
Wed 28th Jan - St Andrew's

Groups who would like to run a Coffee Morning
please call Lynda Briggs on 07904 055 259
or email lebriggs@hotmail.co.uk



ADVERTISING IN LOOKAROUND

For advertisers key points to note are as follows :-

- ◇ We will print an advert supplied by you, or design one for you.
- ◇ If you supply the advert please give it to us as a MS Publisher file, an MS Word file or a jpeg. We will print adverts supplied as pdfs but the quality may suffer.
- ◇ We accept hardcopy adverts and will try to reproduce them. Please let us know if you require a specific font.
- ◇ Adverts will be printed in the sizes specified below and should be supplied in one of these sizes.
- ◇ If you buy a year's worth of advertising (11 adverts) we will only charge you for 10.
- ◇ New advertisers buying 3 months or more worth of adverts will get an extra one free.
- ◇ Further details may be found in the Lookaround Information Section.

Advertising Rates

Single Column 2.56" x 2"	=£12.00
Single Column 2.56" x 3"	=£15.00
Single Column 2.56" x 4"	=£18.00
Single Column 2.56" x 5"	=£21.00
Single Column 2.56" x 7.5"	=£30.00
Double Column 5.2" x 2"	=£18.00
Double Column 5.2" x 3"	=£24.00
Double Column 5.2" x 4"	=£30.00
Colour ads inside front cover	
Double Column 5.2" x 4"	=£50.00
Double Column 5.2" x 7.5"	=£100.00
Other	
B & B and Camp-sites	= £2.00
Personal & Small Ads	= £1.00

CONTACT INFORMATION

Email:

editor@sedberghlookaround.org.uk

Phone:

07464 895425

Address:

**Lookaround,
72 Main Street,
Sedbergh,
Cumbria,
LA10 5AD**

Items can also be delivered by hand to Sedbergh & District Tourist Information Centre at the above address (72 Main Street) during open hours, and deposited in the Lookaround Post Box inside the office,

PAYMENT INFORMATION

CHEQUE

Cheques Payable to :

Sedbergh & District Lookaround

BACS

Account:

Sedbergh and District Lookaround

Account Number:

23388557

Sort Code:

20-55-41

Reference:

Invoice Number and your name or reference.

**WHEN PAYING BY BACS
PLEASE REMEMBER TO
INCLUDE THE INVOICE
NUMBER IN THE
REFERENCE**

LATE NIGHT OPENING

Ed Welty

By the time this is published we'll be almost there.

Don't forget that this year all of Main Street will be closed from the White Hart down to Westwood Books. If you are using the car park you'll need to exit up Joss Lane,

Just as a reminder here's the schedule again:-

Programme for Late Night Opening.

17:00 Craft Market opens in St Andrews

17:00 Start of procession, Drum Nation leads down Main Street

17:10 Santa turns on lights

17:15 – 17:30 Drum Nation at Sedbergh Information Centre

17:30 – 19:30 Santa's Grotto at Sedbergh Information Centre

17:30 – 18:00 Church bells

18:00 Drum Nation at Westwood Books

18:00 – 19:00 Organ recital in St Andrews

18:15 – 19:00 Town Band at bus shelter

18:15 – 19:00 Live Nativity in church yard

18:30 – 19:00 Carol singers in church yard

19:00 – 19:15 Drum Nation – bus shelter to end Main St

20:00 Craft market finishes

All that remains is to say a big thanks to the organising committee, those running events, the shops and businesses for participating, and to

Seasons Greetings To You

**From All
At
LOOKAROUND**

Sedbergh Information Centre & Howgills Bookshop



We offer

A range of gifts for adults and children including
Sedbergh Soap & Kate's Jewellery
Books, walking guides and maps
Cards and locally made goods
Newspapers and magazines for sale

We also offer photocopying services and stamps
Open daily 10am - 4pm



Christmas Cards, Gifts and 2026 Calendars now in stock.
Please come in and report any issues with the Sedbergh Bus Services.

everybody who is planning to attend.
Let's make it another evening to
remember.

Finally a thank you to all those
businesses who sponsored the
event, your support is vital and much
appreciated :-

Andrew Mattinson
E.L.B. Plumbing
J.M.P.
MK Conversions
Our anonymous donors
Sedbergh Lookaround
Sedbergh Weavers
The Thirsty Rambler
Westwood Books
Woofs of Sedbergh

BOOK TOWN BOOK QUIZ

Gerry Cotter

A monthly quiz to test your
knowledge of the world of books. If
you enjoy buying books a programme
of fairs run by North West Book Fairs
is available from the Howgills
Bookshop at 72 Main Street,
Sedbergh.

1. Who wrote A Clockwork
Orange?

2. The Diary of a Young Girl was
published in 1947 and translated into
English in 1952. Who was the young
girl?

3. Julia Ward Howe: 'He is
trampling out the vintage where ----
are stored.' The missing four words
were taken as the title of a novel

published in 1939. What was the title and who wrote it?

4. Who wrote the plays Hay Fever, Private Lives, Cavalcade, Present Laughter and This Happy Breed?

5. Published in 1937, British Birds was the first in which series of books that now stands at 100 titles, the final one having appeared in 2003?

6. Alan Paton's 1948 novel Cry, The Beloved Country is set in which country?

7. The Handmaid's Tale, Alias Grace, The Blind Assassin, Oryx and Crake and The Testaments are some of the many works of this Canadian novelist and poet. Who?

8. He produced his first railway timetable in 1839. He died in 1853, but timetables and travel guides

bearing his surname were published until 1961. What was the surname?

9. Which detective's final case was described in The Private Patient, published in 2008, 46 years after he first appeared? And who created him?

10. What was the title of the collection of poems by William Wordsworth and Samuel Taylor Coleridge, published in 1798, that is seen as the beginning of the English Romantic movement in literature?

11. He was the University of Oxford's Professor for Public Understanding of Science from 1995 until 2008. His books include The Selfish Gene, The Blind Watchmaker, Unweaving the Rainbow, The Ancestor's Tale, The God Delusion

Sedbergh

LATE
NIGHT
SHOPPING

STREET ENTERTAINMENT

SANTA'S GROTTO

(BOOKING FROM 20TH NOVEMBER)

TOWN BAND
CAROLS



3RD DEC
5PM TIL 8PM



STREET FOOD
ORGAN RECITAL
MARKET STALLS
SHOPS & PUBS OPEN



SEDBERGH INFORMATION CENTRE: 015396 20125

and The Greatest Show on Earth.
Who is he?

12. 'So they went off together. But wherever they go, and whatever happens to them along the way, in that enchanted place on the top of the Forest a little boy and his Bear will always be playing.' Of which book are these the closing words?

RUDOLF IS A FRAUD

Myles Ripley

Rudolf the reindeer is often seen at Christmas but he is a fraud..... Male reindeer drop their antlers in the autumn after their breeding season is over. Only female reindeer have antlers at this time of year. So had Rudolf redefined his gender? Is he a genetic freak? And what about his companions Donner, Blitzen et al? Of course Vixen, Dancer and Prancer may be female but who knows?

The other interesting story about Reindeer which may relate to their task of getting round the whole world in just one night.... Or their belief that they do. Are they on drugs? It is well established that Sami Shamans used hallucinogenic mushrooms to induce spiritual trances. Those mushrooms are quite common in Lapland so maybe the reindeer are grazing on them?

Why did Rudolf have a red nose? Some humans with red noses are accused of excessive alcohol consumption. Is Rudolf drunk over Christmas? Is he a safe driver to lead the sleigh?

You may enjoy watching "The magical tale of Santa's reindeer" with your children this Christmas available on You Tube.

SEDBERGH TOWN BAND

Gemma Suttle

What a year it's been for Sedbergh Town Band! Here's a look back at what we've been up to and what's still to come before the year is out.

We kicked off the year in style with a much-enjoyed Dance Night at the People's Hall. The evening provided an opportunity to socialise and enjoy live music in a relaxed, informal setting. March also saw the Training Band taking centre stage at the Spring Show. This event was a brilliant opportunity for our newer players to showcase their hard work and perform in front of a supportive audience.

May was a particularly busy month: Levens Hall, with its historic house and landscaped gardens, provided a picturesque backdrop for an afternoon of music, while performances at Grayrigg and Thornton-in-Lonsdale allowed the

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band to connect with audiences slightly further afield.

June's diary reflected the unpredictability of the British weather. A highlight of the month was the band's visit to Hesket Newmarket, a new venue that we very much hope to return to. It was a hugely successful addition to the calendar, with players and local residents alike making the most of the sunshine. In contrast, the much-anticipated Finkle Street Party fell victim to the rain, and the band was unable to play - the one gig this year where the weather truly beat us! We look forward to being part of this again next year.

August brought us to Sheepfest, where the band provided a lively soundtrack to one of the town's most distinctive events. From jaunty marches to well-known favourites, it was a fun day of music, community, and (of course) sheep!

In September, we travelled to Ingleton, continuing a tradition of performing in and for neighbouring communities. Another friendly audience and another enjoyable outing for the band.

One of the most meaningful events of the year was the band's Remembrance Concert. Through generous donations from those who attended, the concert raised £800 for the Royal British Legion. The programme featured reflective and commemorative music, together with readings, and offered an opportunity for the community to come together in remembrance of those who have served and sacrificed.

Although the year is nearly over, December promises to be one of the

busiest months in the band's calendar, with a series of festive engagements planned.

On 3 December, the band will perform during Sedbergh's late night opening. The band's Christmas Concert is on 6 December at 6 p.m. This family-friendly evening will feature a mix of seasonal favourites, carols and Christmas classics, with a special appearance by Father Christmas himself. Later in the month, on 14 December, the band will be carolling at Lakeland and on 19 December, members of the band will support the local schools' Carol Service. Finally, on 23 December, the band will be spreading festive cheer with carolling around town.



St Andrew's Church, Sedbergh

CONCERT

Sedbergh Orchestra

Conductor Roland Fudge
Leader - Nicola Crawford

2.00 pm Saturday 13th December

Symphony No 3 Eroica - Beethoven
Polovetsian Dances - Borodin
music played by violinists
from local schools

Tickets £8 (£10 on the door)
18 and under free
Tickets from Sedbergh Information
Centre and orchestra members

Doors open 1.45pm

Sedbergh Town Band's achievements this year have only been made possible by the commitment of its players, the leadership of Bandmaster Iwan Lewis, and the tireless work of volunteers behind the scenes. Equally important has been the continued support from audiences, event organisers, and the wider community, whose enthusiasm and appreciation make every performance worthwhile.

If you are interested in becoming a member of Sedbergh Town Band, we meet on Tuesday evenings in St. Andrew's Church, and you can always be sure of a warm welcome. Even if you have never played an instrument before you will find a

home in Training Band until you are ready to join Main Band.

Band members are provided with an instrument, music, tuition and uniform. There is a small annual subscription with fundraising taking place throughout the year to cover major costs. If you would like to find out more, please contact Stephen Hall at sedberghtownbandsecretary@outlook.com or come along to a rehearsal. We would love to see you!

Rehearsals start at 6 p.m. for Training Band, followed by Main Band at 7 p.m.

Sedbergh Town Band wishes you all a very Happy Christmas, and we look forward to seeing you in the New Year.

C BERRY WINDOW CLEANING SERVICES

CARL WOULD LIKE TO THANK ALL HIS VALUED CUSTOMERS AND WISH EVERYONE A MERRY CHRISTMAS AND PROSPEROUS NEW YEAR



07827 813 974



LAKELAND VOICES Singing in the Season

David Burbidge

I often sing as I walk or cycle.

The English sailors for hundreds of years would sail into foreign ports, singing shanties as they pulled on ropes - so much so that they were known as "the singing English." They weren't singing because they were happy - living on weevilly biscuits, tossed around in deadly storms, flogged if they disobeyed orders. They sang because that's how they kept their spirits alive in the face of constant fear and danger.



In October 1966, a huge pile of coal mining waste slid down a hillside onto the Welsh village Aberfan, causing the deaths of 144 people - 116 of them children. The grief in the community was enormous - but for the men of the village bound by mid 20th century male cultural mores, the only outlet for their grief was through

singing - and there was an explosion of new male voice choirs in the valley following the disaster.

Singing relies on the patterns in music and the release of emotion through the voice - connecting the two hemispheres of the brain which deal with these different functions. The singers are empowered in their expression of difference - but are also united in a common experience of harmony and music. It creates community and conviviality and joy. Many studies show that singing releases "happy hormones" such as serotonin leading to a sense of well being.

If you are thinking of doing more singing in 2026, don't wait for the new year to fulfill your resolutions - Advent is very much the season of song with community singing in pubs and churches - or in the workshops which I lead teaching the folk carols and harmonies, allowing singers to

come together as impromptu choirs, even if they have never sung before.

You are all invited to come and learn these lively seasonal songs, sometimes referred to as "pub carols" after the tradition of singing what were formerly West Gallery carols in packed-out pubs. When the West Gallery choirs who sang in country churches between 1700 and 1850 were banned by the Victorian church reformers, many of them moved into the pubs where there was already a tradition of singing in "Glee clubs" - where their descendants are still singing to this day...and where you can join them during this season of goodwill and harmony singing.

There are workshops to learn the carols in the Dent Meditation Centre over the first weekend in December - and singers coming together from several local community choirs to sing together in the Station Inn at Ribbleshead from 6pm on Wednesday December 3; in Dent over the first weekend in December; at Farfield on December 13; and in the New Union tavern in Kendal on December 16. There are details on the Lakeland Voice website.

Come and join us in the singing - all are welcome regardless of previous experience. Then we will make the cobwebs on the rafters shiver like ghosts - and wish you all a very merry and melodious Christmas, and a happy and harmonious new year!

David Burbidge, Lakeland Voice,
Smithy Cottage, Farfield, Sedbergh,
Cumbria LA10 5LW Tel.
015396.21166
www.lakelandvoice.com

LEVENS CHOIR "A Winter's Journey"

Harriet Pollock

Levens Choir, based in South Cumbria, was founded 50 years ago by Ian Jones, when a few friends would meet weekly in Levens village school to indulge their passion for choral music. It soon established a reputation of high performance standards and innovative programming. Gawain Glenton succeeded Ian as Music Director in 2022 and in addition to his choral work, is a virtuoso cornetto player and co-director of the English Cornett & Sackbut Ensemble.

Our concert includes an eclectic assortment of pieces with a seasonal theme, spanning the 16th century to



A Winter's Journey

Levens Choir

Musical director Gawain Glenton

St John's Church
Silverdale LA5 0RH
7:30pm Saturday 13th December 2025

St Mary's Church
Kirkby Lonsdale LA6 2AX
3:00pm Sunday 14th December 2025

Tickets £15

www.levenschoir.net
or on the door

Children & Students Free


<https://www.facebook.com/LevensChoirMusic>


Charity Number 1010595

the present day. The glories of the Renaissance are represented by works by Palestrina, Lassus (the Divine Orlando) and Clemens non Papa, also Viadana, Mikplaj Zielinski and Jean Mouton (b 1459). On the way to the 21st century, we stop off to include works by Gustav Holst and Herbert Howells. Arriving at the present day, some of the contemporary artists included are very well-known. We also take particular pleasure in introducing composers who may not yet be known to some of our audiences. At this concert we present pieces by Joanna Marsh and Will Todd, Bob Chilcott and Rebecca Dale.

The December concerts would not be complete without a selection of Christmas carols, and of course we oblige! We hope to welcome you to this feast of diverse musical delights.

Tickets £15 (free to children and students) on-line at levenschoir.net, from choir members or on the door (subject to availability). As an aspiring "eco-choir", we encourage our audiences to car-share or use public transport wherever possible, thank you.

Sunday 14th December at 3.00pm in St Mary's Church, Kirkby Lonsdale.

The People's Hall

Howgill Lane, Sedbergh LA10 5DQ

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Availability calendar and forms at

sedberghpeopleshall.org

For bookings email

booking.peopleshall@gmail.com

WESTWOOD BOOKS

December Update

Heather & Paul Thomas

Welcome to our latest update for the Lookaround, to keep local people informed about what's happening at Westwood Books. We hope it's helpful.

Upcoming Events

We are delighted to be joining in with Christmas Late Night Opening on Wednesday 3rd December. The bookshop will be open from 10:30am – 8pm that day.

Do pop in for some bookish Christmas shopping. We also have Christmas cards, Christmas roll wrap and calendars and diaries for 2026 available in the shop now.

If there are books that you'd like but can't find in the shop, do ask and we can most likely order them in for you.

We also sell National Book Tokens and Westwood Books Gift Cards. Perfect for the bookish people in your life if you're not sure which book to pick.

Book Club – Second Wednesday of the month, 7pm at the bookshop

Our November book club was another lively discussion, this time about *Gods of the Morning* by John Lister-Kaye. His beautiful words had some of us wanting to book a Scottish wilderness break.

Our next book is *Fifteen Wild Decembers* by Karen Powell, which we will be discussing on Wednesday 10th December. Our book club will have been running for one whole year. Big thank you to everyone who has come along and joined in throughout the year.

We will be continuing to meet on the second Wednesday of every month and we'd love to see new members if you're keen to join. Just get in touch and we can add you to the list. You don't have to come every month. If we're reading a book that you like the sound of, please do just drop in for that month. Our book club is free to attend and there's a free hot drink when you arrive. Book club members also get 10% discount off that month's book if you buy it from us.

Thank You

Finally, a big thank you to everyone who has supported the book shop throughout 2025. We really do appreciate it. 2026 will see the 20th year of Westwood Books in Sedbergh, so hopefully we will have some celebrations – watch this space!

We hope you have a wonderful Christmas and New Year. Best wishes from us both.

KILVINGTON SOLICITORS

Kilvington Solicitors

Kilvington Solicitors, Kirkby Stephen well known for providing an efficient and friendly service to their clients throughout the Eden Valley and beyond, has expanded its legal services to include matters of a contentious nature.

This development is a natural progression for the firm, enabling it to offer a wider range of legal assistance to its clients, supporting them not only with non-contentious legal work but also when disputes arise. The dispute resolution department deals with a wide range of contentious matters, including those involving contracts, construction, land property, and neighbour disputes, estate administration, and professional negligence.

The department has two fee earners, Grace Wren and Bernadette Jackson, who have a wealth of experience in handling all types of civil cases. Grace Wren first came to Kilvington Solicitors as a student over 10 years ago and after gaining a distinction in her Legal Practice Course went to work for a large firm in Carlisle. She is now in her fifth year of practising and has experience in dealing with a variety of disputes from debt claims to landlord and tenant matters but has particular expertise in contentious probate (concerning wills and estate administration) and trust related issues. Grace also deals with divorce and family matters.

Bernadette Jackson has worked as a litigator since 2005. She is dual



TROTT CELEBRATION CONCERT

3pm Sunday December 14th
Thornley Studio, Sedbergh School

Performances from young local
musicians who are benefitting
from the legacy of Freda Trott.

ALL WELCOME to listen
or find out more.

Details at www.trottmusic.co.uk

Stephenson & Wilson

15 Fell Close, Sedbergh LA10 5AP

General Builders

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Fire Places Fitted

Paul Stephenson

015396 21557

07810 595543



Tom Wilson

015396 20954

07790 946578

qualified, qualifying as a barrister in 2003 with one of the highest pass marks before then completing her dual qualification as a solicitor in 2008, passing with Grade A. Her areas of expertise and experience have particularly focused on commercial, construction, consumer rights in relation to both sale of goods and services, professional negligence, debt recovery, land and neighbour disputes.

Managing Director, Litini Newcombe, said "we are excited to have broadened the scope of our services. Our goal has always been to meet the needs of our clients and whilst no one wants to be involved in a dispute, unfortunately we have seen a significant rise in the demand for legal support in this area and therefore feel it is something we should provide so that clients do not have to go further afield for assistance."

For more information about Kilvington Solicitors including the other legal services they offer please visit their website - www.kilvingtonsolicitors.co.uk

SEDBERGH MEAD

Sarah Singleton

When Sarah decided to start a mead business with her partner Russ, it wasn't the bee stings she was most worried about — it was whether she'd like the taste of the honey wine. She'd got so swept up in their plan for a local business from their beekeeping hobby that she hadn't even tried the drink before she'd committed.

Luckily she loved it, and now Sedbergh has a new product: Sedbergh Mead.

Sarah and Russ' combined background spans military service and running a chemical company. They live locally and share a love of Sedbergh's countryside, they wanted



a wholesome business rooted in nature.

Working with honey from their own hives, as well as honey from across the Yorkshire Dales, the business hand-ferments, hand-bottles and hand-labels each batch. They've already been busy bees experimenting with flavours. Sarah's favourite is Rhubarb and Ginger — usually a gin pairing, but testing proved it works beautifully with mead too. With a sweet tooth, Russ can't get enough of the Sweet Mead. Other flavours include citrus and a spiced version just in time for Christmas.

Earlier this year they even had a hive swarm, which decided to settle in a neighbour's tree. While trying to scoop them out, the entire cluster fell onto Russ' face, a chaotic moment, but very much part of the learning curve.

Sedbergh Mead can be purchased from their website, www.bumbledore.co.uk

— a nod to Harry Potter and the joy of potions. You can follow their latest updates on Instagram @sedbergh_mead. A range of local events is coming up, and in the spirit of community (the kindness kind, not the alcoholic kind), they're offering free delivery to all residents.

By welcoming Sedbergh Mead, the town gains a product that reflects the quality and creativity of the area — something the community can enjoy, support and be proud to call its own.



SEDBERGH SPRING SHOW

Valerie Welti

With a new organising team I'm sure you will agree that the Spring Show 2025 was a great occasion for all the family. Our show opener Abbi Lawson (former contestant on the Great British Bake-Off) thoroughly enjoyed her day with us and was very impressed with the creativity in evidence in Sedbergh and the surrounding district. Saturday 21st March 2026 will give us the opportunity to celebrate those creative skills again in the Peoples Hall. Thank you to everyone who entered items last year - we had 100 more entries in 2025. It would be wonderful to have even more on display in 2026.

As promised, the full list of classes appears at the end of this article. The favourite classes are still there; some new ones have replaced less popular ones. Please have a look at the Junior Section. We always like to see the involvement of the younger members of our community and a couple of new classes will give adult family members — grandparents, aunts, uncles - the chance to start younger relatives off on what may become life-long hobbies. There is a new class in the Garments and Accessories section to knit something for a premature baby. Patterns are available on the Bliss website, a charity for babies born premature or sick, www.bliss.org.uk.

Entry forms will be available in Sedbergh shops and Information Centre by the end of February 2026. There will be no charges to enter items into the show, just an

BURNS NIGHT CEILIDH & SUPPER

With STRIDING EDGE Band

Sunday 25th January at 7 PM.

People's Hall, Sedbergh

£15:00 includes Haggis sausage and mash
(vegetarian/vegan options on request)

Please specify when booking tickets.

Pre-paid tickets only.

CASH bar and raffle only.

Proceeds to North West Air Ambulance
& St. John's Hospice.

Please email Jane Fisher for tickets

jane21@live.com



admission fee to come into the
Spring Show on Saturday March
21st.

Last year we were delighted to
include work from pupils at Dent
Primary as well as from Sedbergh
Primary and Settlebeck High School.

With music from Finkle Folk and
Sedbergh Town Band to listen to and
tea, scones and cakes in the
committee room whilst chatting with
friends and family it will be an
enjoyable afternoon.

If you have any queries or want to
join the team at their next meeting on
December 4th 10.00 am please
contact Valerie Welti
valerie.welti@btinternet.com, 07969
376649

So here are the classes for 2026.
Find some that inspire you, and start
planning your entries now that the
dark Winter evenings have set in.

Handicrafts

A patchwork or quilted item

Transformation challenge - any
cloth item handcrafted from
repurposed material (including a bag
or a garment)

A wooden item

A stitched image (can be cross
stitch, needlepoint, or embroidery)

A handmade cushion (max size
40cm)

A handwoven item (including
woven tapestry)

A handmade card

A Spring wreath (non perishable)

A handcrafted soft toy (sewn,
knitted or crocheted)

A piece of fused, stained, or
decorated glass

A piece of hand-made jewelry
(including ear-rings, pendants,
necklaces, brooches)

Any other handcrafted item
(including felted items & candles)

GARMENTS & ACCESSORIES

A hand knitted garment (for adult,
child or baby)

A hand knitted item for premature
babies (to be donated to a neo-natal
unit)

A hand knitted scarf, snood, shawl,
hat or blanket

A crocheted garment or accessory

Flowers and Plants

To reduce plastic pollution we ask
entrants to use natural alternatives to
oasis. We also encourage entrants to
use natural local and seasonally
available flowers and plants. A large

houseplant Ht 30cm and over
(excluding pot)

A small houseplant Ht under 30cm
(excluding pot)

A dinner table arrangement (Max
size W/D 45cm)

A garden in a box (Max size W/D
45cm)

An arrangement in a basket (Max
size W/D 45cm)

A Spring Hedgerow arrangement

Home Produce

Four cheese scones

Fruit cake

Loaf cake

Four Fruit Scones

Six biscuits of any variety

Four cupcakes

Gingerbread

Any sponge cake (of any flavour)

Shortbread

Six flapjack pieces

Six pieces from a tray bake

A pasty (sweet, savoury, meat or
vegetarian)

Savoury quiche

Four "sausage" rolls (vegetarian or
meat filling)

A jar of raspberry or strawberry jam

A jar of any other jam

A jar of Seville orange marmalade

A jar of any other fruit marmalade

A jar of fruit jelly

A jar of lemon or lime curd

A jar of chutney

A jar of piccalilli

A jar of fermented food (e.g.
kimchi, sauerkraut, kombucha, kefir)

Bottle of sloe /damson gin or any
other fruit spirit

Bottle of any cordial or non-
alcoholic fruit drink

A handmade sourdough loaf of
bread

A handmade loaf of any other
bread

Art

Still Life - any media

Abstract - any media

Landscape - any media

Portrait - any media

A page from your sketch book

Photograph

All creatures great and small (size
minimum 8x6, maximum 12x10)

Local Vistas(Cumbria, Lancashire
or Yorkshire) (size minimum 8 x6,
maximum 12 x 10)

Patterns (size minimum 8x6,
maximum 12 x 10)

New Beginnings (size minimum
8x6, maximum 12 x 10)

Decline and Fall (size minimum
8x6, maximum 12x10)



Invites you to watch...

The Penguin Lessons (12)

On Saturday 24th January 2026 at 7.30pm

At the People's Hall, Howgill Lane, Sedbergh

Adult - £7 Child - £3

Family - 2 adults & 2 children (under 16) - £15

Bar & Refreshments - Doors open 6.30pm

Advance tickets at Sedbergh Tourist
Information Centre

Or Cash Only on the door.

A fundraising event for the People's Hall.

Sport For All (size minimum 8x6, maximum 12x10)

Water in all its Forms (size minimum 8x6, maximum 12x10)

Twisted (size, Minimum 8x6, maximum 12x10)

Junior

A decorated handprint (Age 6 and under)

A painted stone (Age 7 - 11)

A model in any material made with help from a family member (Aged 11 and under)

2 chocolate crispy cakes (unbaked) (age 11 and under)

A crocheted granny square made with help from a family member (Aged 11 and under)

2 pieces of Rocky Road (unbaked) (age 16 and under)

Fresh flowers in a decorated wellington boot (Age 16 and under)

Photograph - Something spooky or scary (maximum 5x7) (age 11 and under)

Photograph - Something circular (maximum 5 x7) (age 16 and under)

Photograph - Favourite place (maximum 5x7) (age 16 and under)

A piece of handmade jewelry (age 16 and under)

A handmade card (age 16 and under)

COMMUNITY ORCHARD GROUP SEDBERGH (COGS) 8TH APPLE DAY

Ann Parratt

Apple Day this year was a huge success!

We changed the timing this year to start pressing from 12 noon until 4pm. And what a great time we had, with more people coming than ever, with masses of apples to juice, lots of families came (which we loved) and many visitors as well as local folk. I don't think we could have had any more cars in the car park than we had. It was absolutely packed!

The atmosphere was very relaxed, with people enjoying meeting friends, having their apples juiced and eating yummy cakes.

Outside People's Hall in the sunshine, sheltered from the cold north-west wind, new recruits Kiara and James joined the regulars Jim, Nigel, Steve, Peter and Alan for a record-breaking day on the juicing and bottling lines.

The process of turning apples into juice began with the scratter, a giant electric food processor with sharp steel blades, which noisily turned whole apples into pulp. Next, trugs of



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be available at Open House
Tuesdays 10am - 12 mid-day
Methodist Church at Cornerstone
Join us for coffee and a chat*

*For further information or to arrange a one to one
appointment please call the Grief Share number*



pulp, 40kg at a time, were loaded into the Speidel hydropress where the magic happened. This ingenious machine, powered by water pressure alone, squeezed the pulp to release juice which cascaded out into waiting buckets, watched by a fascinated audience.

Everyone remarked on the abundance of apples this year, thanks to a warm dry spring at pollination time followed by plenty of rain later to swell the fruit. About one tonne of apples were processed into juice, with 27 pressings each producing about 22 litres of juice. The bottling crew were kept very busy with a record 600 litres of apple juice, and very nearly ran out of containers.

We really appreciate all the help people give at this free event, it simply couldn't happen without them.

Inside People's Hall there was lots to do and see. Great music from Common Ground, delicious food to sample as well as to take away and lots of children's activities.

We were delighted to have Cumbria's two leading apple experts with us. Andy Gilchrist and Hilary Wilson brought along their years of experience, and identified apples brought in from gardens, old orchards and allotments. A big thank you to them for their input. People were fascinated to know the type of apples they are growing in their gardens, and were delighted to find out that they are sometimes growing a rare heritage type.

Two local groups were represented, the Sedbergh Beekeepers and Red Squirrel Group - we even had a giant red squirrel wandering around chatting to everyone.

It was great to have Hannah (a COGS member) from Half and Half there too, giving out tots of cider to taste and supporting the event by running Ciderfest over the entire weekend in Main Street.

Local organically grown vegetables were well represented by Sunny Bank Kitchen Garden, a new enterprise to Sedbergh and a very welcome one. The Garden is run by



Charlotte Corns - a member of COGS - and she grows vegetables that are sold through the weekly veg box scheme run by Home Grown Here. Charlotte also organised a Guess-the-Weight-of- the Pumpkin competition on Apple Day.

Last but certainly not least, we had a very successful raffle. Prizes were generously donated by local businesses and friends of COGS. A huge thank you for your donations of wonderful prizes, we really appreciate your contributions.

We raised just over £600 this year, which is a huge help in running the orchard so thank you for your support.

All these activities are run by volunteers, without whom it would be impossible to put on this family friendly event, so a huge thank you from all the members of COGS.

Save the date 24 October 2026 and start saving those bottles now!



SEDBERGH MEDICAL CENTRE

will be closed for Training Purposes at 1pm on the following afternoons:-

2026

Thurs 12th February

Thurs 12th March

Thurs 16th April



SEDBERGH ENVIRONMENTAL MARKET

Michelle Hartley

In mid-October we had our ninth eco market which was another great success with lots of wonderful environmental stalls, some were familiar faces, with others being new ones.

New to the market was Bay Botanicals, who produce beautiful soaps which are ethically sourced and made from sustainable plant-based ingredients. Originally begun at home over 10 years ago, they now have a larger premises and supply numerous outlets including Sizergh Castle. Some soaps are classic scents like Lavender and Patchouli Rose, with other festive smells, including Winter Solstice and Cloves & Pine. Dark Skies Cumbria returned to the market, last being with us in 2022, to inform on the importance of reducing light pollution for the health of both nocturnal wildlife and our own enjoyment of the night sky. The charity looks to help businesses, local authorities and others to reduce their light pollution, while emphasising that they are not about



Sedbergh Parish Council

INTERESTED IN HELPING YOUR LOCAL COMMUNITY? MAKE A DIFFERENCE — BECOME A PARISH COUNCILLOR

Sedbergh Parish Council currently has two casual vacancies, and as no election has been requested, the Council intends to co-opt to fill these positions.

What does the role involve? As a Parish Councillor, you will have the opportunity to:

- Represent the views and interests of residents
- Contribute to decision-making on matters affecting the parish
- Work collaboratively with fellow councillors to improve services and amenities

Play an active part in developing community projects and initiatives

Why get involved? Serving as a Parish Councillor is a rewarding way to contribute to the well-being of your community. It is an excellent opportunity to influence local decisions, support positive change, and help shape the future of the parish.

Who is eligible? To be considered for co-option, you must be 18 years or older and meet at least one of the following criteria:

- You must be a registered voter in the parish of Sedbergh
- Have occupied land or premises in the parish (as owner or tenant) for the last 12 months
- Have had your principal or only place of work within the parish for the last 12 months
- Have resided in the parish, or within 3 miles of it, for the last 12 months

Interested in applying? If you would like to serve as a Parish Councillor, please contact the Clerk to the Council, who will provide an application form (including full eligibility criteria), explain the nature of the role, outline the likely time commitment, and provide information on training available for new Councillors.

Completed application forms (posted or emailed) must be **received by 26 January 2026**. Thank you for your interest in supporting your local community.

Janey Hassam, Clerk to the Council, Sedbergh Parish Council, 72A Main Street, Sedbergh, LA10 5AD
Email: clerk@sedberghparishcouncil.gov.uk

getting rid of all lighting, just bad wasteful lights. Also new was Nimira Artisan Bags, who produces a stunning range of bags, coin purses and earrings utilising leather bound for landfill. The three main sources of this leather are discarded furniture, small businesses disposing of materials and the luxury car market. The range of bags come not only in classic black and brown, but vibrant and beautiful pinks, yellows, blues and more.

Cumbria Master Composters, part of 'Garden Organic', was back with us again and brought along their fascinating wormery, containing tiger and brandling worms, those most commonly found in compost. While

promoting composting in local communities they were also on hand to provide advice and information for those wanting to try it at home. Ferus was new to the market and brought a variety of their recycled and upcycled metal, wood and ceramic products. This husband and wife team produce a wide variety of decorative items, from Christmas baubles to lamps. Their speciality is wonderful decorative metalwork for the garden, all of which have developed a lovely natural rust coating. Dentdale Bees & Mayfair Organics is a local 70-acre farm which is part of 'Organic Farmers and Growers'. A variety of farm products were available for purchase from wax and soaps to

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skeins of organic wool. The animals on the farm are used in conservation grazing, while trees and hedgerows have been planted to improve biodiversity and prevent soil erosion.

For over 60 years the Cumbria Wildlife Trust has worked hard to restore and connect people with wild places. They manage 41 nature reserves in Cumbria, including Burns Beck Moss right on own doorstep and 11 more within a 12-mile radius. They have several projects on the go, including red squirrel conservation work and hay meadow restoration. New to this market was Little Moon Jewellery who is local and produces jewellery using 100% recycled gold and sterling silver, reclaimed from various sources including old

electronics, equipment and industrial scrap. Some pieces include ethically sourced stones and locally collected sea glass. Futureproof Cumbria came to the market, a new name for the previous Cumbria Action for Sustainability. They returned to promote their 'Cold to Cosy Homes' programme, which addresses issues of winter warmth by reducing people's energy consumption. Along with this they had information on their other energy services, including thermal imaging, renewable technology and electric vehicles.

Also new, was the amazing candles from Scented Scapes, they are made of soy wax, while the candle holders are homemade from eco resins, plant rather than



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petroleum based. These candles come in familiar shapes of slim pillars and chunky columns, but also a variety of animal shapes including cats, dogs and sheep. Some of the wonderful scents include Rose & Champagne and Magnolia & Pear. Once again, The Zero Pantry came along from Kirkby Lonsdale to remind us of the wonderful eco products sold in their plastic free shop. They brought a large selection of eco household products, Christmas supplies and a wide variety of pre-packaged meals using ingredients from their store, including rocky road, granola bars and their tasty Christmas Cake mix.

The Sedbergh Primary School PTFA were also back selling tea, coffee and homemade cakes at the market. The school has an Eco-Schools Bronze Award and encourages a connection with nature through its nature gardens, bug hotels and taking part in Forest

School activities. Lastly, was our very own Sedbergh Tree Group, who have planted tens of thousands of trees and hedges across the local area. They are always on the lookout for more volunteers to help plant and check-up on the trees, along with new land to plant on. If you can help with either of these please contact via our email or Facebook page.

If you were unable to come to this market, keep an eye out for future events, or if you would like to get involved in the next market or the Sedbergh Environmental Network contact us at sedberghecomarket@greencobweb.co.uk. If you would like more information or the contact details for the stalls, please get in touch. There are so many ways to help the environment, please visit our Facebook page for information, tips and to learn about other eco events nearby!

COMMUNITY FIRST RESPONDERS

Myles Ripley

What we do NOT do.....

You cannot ring us up directly and ask for our help. We can only respond to tasks assigned by North West Ambulance Service (NWAS). You need to phone 999 to alert NWAS to your need.

We only get assigned to the most serious two categories. Cat 1 is for immediately life threatening situations like cardiac arrests. Cat 2 calls are for serious but not immediately life-threatening emergencies, such as a stroke. Less serious situations like falls are not in our scope of practice partly because we do not have the sometimes necessary lifting equipment.

We are not allowed to attend calls involving under 12 year olds, calls on the motorway and, in most cases, trauma calls.

We are not on duty 24 hours a day. Our Sedbergh team only has 3 members, 2 of whom are in full time employment. We are most consistently available at night. As volunteers we do not work regular hours. We log on when and if we are available.

We do not get given blue lights so we can't arrive at the speed of light. If we are called in the middle of the night consider how long it takes to wake up and get dressed, get equipment into car, sorting out the address and driving to the call.

In October we were activated to 9 calls, 2 of which were stood down as the ambulance could get there quicker. Calls included chest pains,



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breathing difficulties, significant long bleeding, possible stroke and concussion.

We would love to get more members on our team so if you would like to get involved and know more please do get in touch. mylesripley@btinternet.com It doesn't take high level skills but effective training is provided. You only need to be willing to give your time, be 18+ and own your own car.

AN APPEAL FOR VOLUNTEERS

Georgina Devine

The Sedbergh Community First responders need more volunteers!

There are only three of them at the moment -

Ideally, they need two more.

It's not too much pressure. You can choose when you want to sign on

To be on call.

In the day, the afternoon or the evening.

If someone calls an ambulance to their home,

The community first responder is called by the ambulance service

To sit with the caller in their house.

They have life-saving equipment such as defibrillators

If people are having a heart attack.

It's not outdoors.

They help with first aid.

Contact Myles for the details.

Volunteers do first aid training first.

If you don't fancy volunteering with the first responders,

You can volunteer in the charity clothes shop

Or the charity bookshop or the tourism information centre,

Or the Western Dales bus!

Or the voluntary car scheme.

There's not too much pressure -

It's just nice and relaxing.

Meeting the customers and the passengers on the bus.

I sent a copy of the Sedbergh Lookaround to Anne

Which has details of all these volunteer opportunities.

Anne says it was lovely to receive the magazine from Georgina

Lots of volunteers make the magazine too



OPEN Friday to Sunday 9.30 - 4:00

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Open for **XMAS MENU** bookings
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PUMPKIN PARTY DENT

Sarah Woof

What an amazing time we had on Hallowe'en at our Pumpkin Party: we gave away 40 bags containing a little book and sweeties. We realise the books were the same as last year so will organise something else for next year.

Some of the costumes were extraordinary but in a good way; we welcomed children of all ages along with parents and grandparents. The rain stayed away and there was a definite buzz in the air as everyone made their way around the village.

An impromptu game of football took place on the lawn in semi darkness, and the amount of sugar consumed that week would be astronomical! We were happy to play our part.

Our carved Pumpkins didn't light too well as it was either too windy or too wet, but they all shone in the darkness at least once. The big white PEACE pumpkin had Poppys painted on it for Remembrance Day.

Have a blessed Christmas and a healthy New Year.

METHODIST CHURCH DENTDALE

Sarah Woof

What a year we have had, total refurbishment of our Schoolroom, sharing of services with our friends at St Andrew's, Dent, and St John's at Cowgill and other Methodist congregations.

Meetings about this and that and the other, becoming part of the Cumbria-wide Circuit and keeping our "Chapel" warm, inviting and open. The all-age services led by Ben Maunder are such fun and show us 'bit older young at heart folk ' how to let our hair down and still worship God! Our monthly coffee mornings are great social occasions.

But we have not yet held an event to celebrate the refurbishment;

somehow this got overtaken by other things. Never say never! We will be celebrating around our anniversary on the first weekend of March. So please reserve Saturday Feb 28th in the afternoon for the service of celebration followed by tea and cake, especially if you were in any way involved with the work to refurbish the schoolroom. Or if you have connections with Methodists in the Dale or Dent "Chapel" in particular. More info nearer the time.

Meanwhile we look forward to a Christmas Celebration service for all ages on Sunday Dec 21st at 10.30am with the cafe from 9.30am. Our normal service plan is the first and third Sundays and you will always be welcome.

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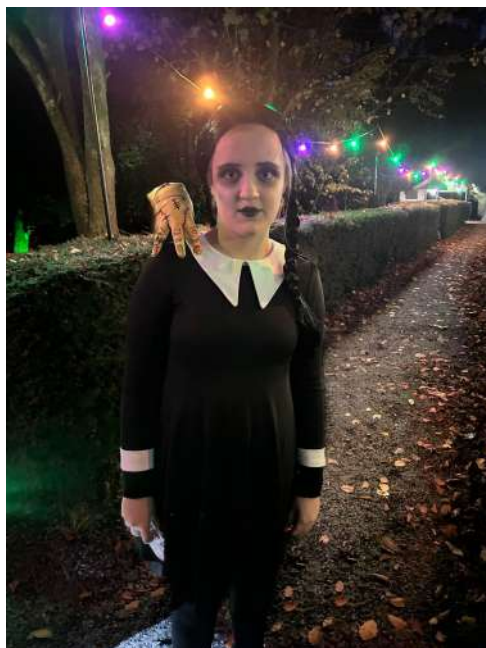
DL8 5EH

SPELLBOUND THEATRE

Heather Pakeman

The Queen's Gardens Halloween trail was a great event for the community. Many thanks should go to Ian Hutt and his family along with Steve Longlands, Andrew Allan, and Pieter Woudenberg who spent many hours setting up and displaying spooky props and twinkly lighting. A variety of props were made by Sedbergh School students and the Hutt family.

Spellbound Theatre funded the use of the generator and enjoyed adding a bit of spookiness portraying some of the Addams family. Wet and chilly apple bobbing proved to be a bone shaking experience for anyone brave enough to try.



Matthew Cook

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SEDBERGH BRIDGE CLUB

Peter Cox

The long-established Sedbergh Bridge Club meets on Friday mornings (10.30 - 13.00) in the Education Room at Farfield Mill. We always welcome new members: even those who have just started learning the basics of Bridge are welcome to come along to observe play and to ask any questions.

Our bridge play is of a social nature (Rubber Bridge as opposed to Duplicate). You do not need to bring a partner, as everybody gets a game! Fees are very moderate, and we would invite any prospective newcomers to attend a couple of sessions free of charge. The café at the Mill is available for the purchase of pre-Bridge coffee, as is lunch afterwards.

For more information, please telephone David Alison on 01539 824666, or email him at tracks.north2@gmail.com

We look forward to hearing from you and to meeting you at our friendly Club.



POLICE REPORT

PCSO Mandy Coleman

Logs of note for the area of Sedbergh are as follows:

27/10 - 1 person was arrested in the area following a positive Drugs wipe.

2/11 – 1 person was arrested for threats made with a bladed article/offensive weapon in a public place.

9/11 - A suspicious vehicle was reported in the area between Sedbergh and Tebay outside a residential dwelling. This was checked out and the vehicle stopped. All was in order and someone was being dropped off after a night out.

10/11 – 1 person was arrested in the area of Cowgill for drink driving.

The festive period is swiftly around the corner. Crime rates can increase due to longer winter nights and the distraction of holiday activities. To prevent crime during this period, it is essential to take proactive measures during this time.

Enhance Outdoor Lighting, use motion sensor lights, to deter any potential burglars.

Secure your property, install deadbolt and new window hinges, ensure doors are locked even when you are home. Consider using a plug timer.

Be cautious on Social Media! Avoid posting your whereabouts or photos of valuable items.

Stay Vigilant, if you notice anything suspicious, report it.

The next police drop in for the area of Sedbergh is 1st of December at the Community Office 10am – 11am.



HARDSHIP & EXHIBITION FUNDS

John Sykes

Hardship Fund:

If you are in financial need or have a real need for an item which you do not have the wherewithal to buy, then the Sedbergh United Charities may be able to help you. Or, if a friend or neighbour is in need of financial help then please let them know about us. The Charities also have an

Exhibition Fund:

For under 25-year-olds for help with educational or training needs. To apply for help from, or should you wish to make a donation to, the Charities then please contact:

Tony Reed Screen
(a865@btinternet.com or 015396 21081) or John Sykes
(jmsykes100@gmail.com or 07786 384 917).

Any application will be treated in confidence. Sedbergh United Charities and Widow's Hospital - Registered Charity No. 231058



NOTES FROM DENT STATION

John Carey

It has been busy at the station, and we are fortunate in that bookings remain healthy. As I have often said, the visitor income is vital to supporting the heavy costs of conservation and upkeep of the historic building, but, in particular, it helps to keep the heating on during the winter period. On a separate note, it won't be long before we have road access via Newby Head again which will be a relief to our guests and volunteers. It has been a nightmare! Again, a big thank you to the 'Cowgill Escape Committee' who have worked hard to make this happen.

Much as anticipated, the seasonal leaf fall has been causing problems for the railway with trains struggling to gain adhesion on occasions. The rails are treated daily with high pressure water, and the rail head treatment train usually makes its journey southbound in the afternoon, returning northbound in the evening. But to add to the woes, there was a major power outage at Blea Moor affecting signalling and points on a recent Saturday. Trains came to a standstill each side of Blea Moor and a passenger train was stuck at Dent Station for nearly 2 hours. Dent

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Station is not renowned for its amenities and fortunately some were able to avail themselves of the facilities in the house. On the plus side, there was plenty of time to admire the view from the platform!

On another occasion, a quarry train broke down at Selside, effectively blocking the northbound line. It should be added that the quarry trains have to travel north to Blea Moor in order to turn back, a somewhat questionable use of resources caused by the lack of the once extant pointwork. There are considerable problems in moving a failed heavy freight train and, invariably, this will involve providing another locomotive. With the rail industry fragmented and a number of different operators, calling up a rescue locomotive is not an easy task. Again, passengers were caused to wait on stranded trains in one case nearly 4 hours at Horton.

But just as I write, the line is again

affected by flooding, this time in north Cumbria, leading to a number of cancellations, some because staff could not get to work. Whilst the general consensus is that the increase in such events is probably a consequence of global warming, it is also possibly the case that maintenance regimes are less regular than they might have been in the past and often on a reactionary basis.

The above incidents, whilst not everyday occurrences, do bring into sharp focus the difficulties faced on our line, particularly with the imminent arrival of the West Coast Main Line diversions which will occur for the first two weeks of January 2026 and thereafter. It is to be hoped that Network Rail will organise additional on-site staff to deal with problems and suitable rescue locomotives will be standing by.

Meanwhile, there is some evidence of works ongoing to stabilise



embankments, particularly at Dent Head. The problems of slippage due to water logged embankments were recently highlighted on the West Coast Main Line when an early morning Avanti train hit a small landslide following heavy rain. Whilst the train derailed, it was fortunate that it stayed upright and there were few casualties.

Whilst there are no significant developments on our local bus services, the Bus Services Act recently received assent and now provides greater powers for local authorities to run their own services, something which was outlawed in 1985 when bus services were deregulated. At that time municipal bus operations and the National Bus Company undertakings were passed to the private sector. Indeed, Ribble, once part of the National Bus

Company, was eventually absorbed into Stagecoach.

But moving on to more recent times, local authorities were invited to adopt either a Franchise or Enhanced Partnership model of operation in order to gain Bus Service Improvement Plan (BSIP) funding. It is perhaps not surprising that Westmorland and Furness and their Cumbria predecessor chose to adopt the less costly Enhanced Partnership model, with an already established operator in place covering 95% of existing services. The alternative Franchise model, involving complete control of services, would have been costly and has, thus far, only been adopted by the more urban authorities.

Enhanced Partnership preserves the autonomy of the bus operator but, on the down-side, permits far less control by the local authority.

It may seem bizarre having recently separated, but there is every likelihood that Westmorland and Furness will ultimately join with Cumberland under a mayoral authority with devolved powers including a public transport budget. The two authorities already work closely together as regards public transport in any event and share some resources. All of this is quite a way off.



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Meanwhile, the local public transport user group has been doing an excellent job in highlighting the particular transport issues in Sedbergh, the largest town in the Dales and the least well served by public transport. The truth is that despite the size of Sedbergh, the area is fairly sparsely populated and a regular Kendal service covering the full day would not be viable to an operator without some level of council subsidy. However, there is some optimism that the case is being made for council subsidy, and we may even see a regular service in place by April next year. Let's hope so!

Anyway, back to Dent Station, we are fortunate that the S1 Western Dales Bus continues to provide a vital link to and from the station every Saturday and is ideal for a Christmas shopping trip to Carlisle, departing at 0958 from Sedbergh Post Office to Dent Station and then hopping on the 1047 train to Carlisle. This would involve returning on the 1618 train from Carlisle to catch the bus from Dent Station back to Sedbergh. Please check

www.westerndalesbus.co.uk for bus running and times including the current daily services between Kirkby Stephen and Kendal.

I should also remind as to the Dales Railcard, available to residents in the qualifying post codes, which provides a one-third discount for tickets purchased on the day (weekdays after 0815) on the Settle-Carlisle and Morecambe lines. Even better, there is a 50%-off winter offer running until 26th March 2026. The cards can be purchased at a cost of £15 from Skipton, Settle or Appleby stations with proof of address or by application to the Settle Carlisle Railway Development Company via their website.

The portal for most bus journeys in the Yorkshire Dales can be found at www.dalesbus.org. For rail journeys please consult www.northernrailway.co.uk which will also give details of any potential disruption. Meanwhile, if I can be of any assistance on any bus or rail matter, please feel free to contact via john.carey@settle-carlisle.com and, as always, I would be delighted to help.

COAST TO COAST UPGRADE COMPLETED

Andrew Fagg, YDNP

Yorkshire Dales National Park rangers have upgraded a section of the “Coast-to-Coast” path to National Trail quality standard.

A three-kilometre-long stone-flagged surface has been laid over a notoriously treacherous peat bog in Birkdale, part of the Kirkby Stephen to Keld section of the trail.

The final flagstone was laid in October. The story is told in a video published today (see also attached aerial photograph).

Local MP Rishi Sunak campaigned successfully for the Coast-to-Coast path to become a National Trail. He met rangers recently and has congratulated the team for doing a “fantastic job”.

Completion of the work paves the way for Natural England to formally open the Coast-to-Coast National Trail in spring next year.

Area Ranger for Swaledale Michael Briggs has been part of the

team on the ground, engaging with walkers on the trail while marshalling two teams, each comprised of three staff including a digger driver.

After a two-month stint on White Mossy Hill, he said: “For me one of the best parts of the job has been chatting to people walking by. They all love the path we’ve made. There’s been so many international walkers and some were dreading this section because they’d been told how boggy it can be. People could not have been more appreciative.”

A coast-to-coast route from the Irish Sea at St Bee’s in Cumberland to the North Sea at Robin Hood’s Bay was originally described by Alfred Wainwright in 1973. Over time, three pathways emerged to navigate the peatland at White Mossy Hill in Birkdale. The newly surfaced route uses the most popular of the three ways and has become a public right of way in agreement with the local estate.

Rangers began work in August last year with a planned pause for the



delivery of more materials and ground-nesting bird season. Work resumed in August this year for ten weeks.

Member Champion for Recreation Management at the Yorkshire Dales National Park Authority, Lizzie Bushby, said: "The funding we have received from Natural England to enhance the Coast-to-Coast route in Birkdale has proved to be a win-win. We have been able to protect important peatland habitat from damage, while creating a sustainable route for walkers and making it more enjoyable."

"The new stone-flagged path is wide enough for people using mobility aids. It's not a route for everyone, but it will give more people a better chance of getting up to the peaks above Birkdale, one of the most remote places in the National Park. On a fine day you can see all the way down Swaledale from the new path."

"We hope that National Trail status will make the Coast-to-Coast route even more popular, giving a boost to local businesses. There can be few better ways of experiencing the special qualities of the Yorkshire Dales National Park than walking the trail between Kirkby Stephen in Westmorland and Richmond in North Yorkshire."

In addition to the stone-flagged path at Birkdale, signage of the route is being installed throughout the Yorkshire Dales section of the trail, with more than 40 new fingerposts pointing the way and five new bridges so far.

PROTECTING BIRDS OF PREY Inside the Work of UK Wildlife Crime Policing

Victoria Benn, Friends of the Dales

Following on from its Eyes on the Skies campaign launch in October (watch at: www.youtube.com/@friendsofthedales), Friends of the Dales next campaign event will be an online talk taking place Tuesday 27 January, 5:30pm – 7:00pm:

Join Detective Inspector Mark Harrison of the UK National Wildlife Crime Unit for insight into the real-world challenges of protecting vulnerable and endangered birds of prey in North Yorkshire.

In this exclusive online talk, Mark will share true stories from the frontline of wildlife crime policing,

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revealing the realities, challenges and successes faced by officers working to safeguard some of our most at-risk species.

He will also address common misconceptions on the role of policing in tackling birds of prey persecution. Expect an honest and informative discussion about:

- The key challenges in investigating bird of prey crimes
 - What's working well and where improvements are needed
 - Future plans, strategies, and innovative policing tactics
 - And, a look at a few fascinating real-life cases
- Book your free place here: www.friendsofthedales.org.uk/ events

You can also sign up to Friends of the Dales monthly e newsletter on its website homepage to be kept up to date with all Eyes on the Skies campaign developments and future events.



FAMILY MUSINGS.

Sarah Woof

My Mum used to say she knew what sort of a day she was going to have within an hour of getting out of bed! If things went well then it would be a good day, if they went badly then she'd have a bad day. My Dad disagreed and said she put herself in whatever mood which then effected the day. She disproved that theory the day she bounded out of bed singing about a wonderful life, caught her foot in a hole in the bed sheet and catapulted across the room banging her head on the dressing table.

One day recently hubby lost his car key, we looked everywhere, he traced his steps to no avail. Out came the torch to look under the bed, never a good idea unless u have time to tidy up, and I did find them where he had put them perfectly safe. While that was going on a Robin flew into the house and flapped about in panic, armed with a butterfly net I attempted rescue, but it flew out the open door. Surely the day would get better. Later we lost our little car in the supermarket car park, the expression on hubby's face when it wasn't on the far side of a larger car was one of utter bewilderment. Obviously, we did find said car.

As life gets more hectic it's easy to lose things and I am very careful to put important things, i.e. keys, back where they belong. It is some years since I lost a jug of custard and later, after much searching, found it strategically placed in the washing machine. and then remembered putting it there! I am not that

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stressed. But am looking forward to a slightly slower pace of life especially around Christmas. The excitement and joy and wonder of our grandchildren just makes it all so special.

This year someone will be missing from our family, but happy memories of time together will be talked about and treasured. This may also be true for you, treasure the happy memories as, with us, you create new things to look back on in the future. Even the mishaps.

Happy Christmas and a Merry New Year.



MEMORIES OF CHRISTMAS PAST

Dave Smith

So here we go again - yet another school Christmas Fair. I always know that Christmas is imminent when I find myself wandering around the school with £5 worth of change in my pocket, systematically trying to dispose of it at the games and stalls organised by our pupils at the school's Christmas Fair.

The pupils have been enthusiastically working up to it for weeks (just as the teachers have been resignedly wearing down to it) and they've managed to persuade generous local shopkeepers to donate a range of sweet and sticky

fare to proudly award as prizes. The posters have been made, announcing said prizes and indicating what skills will be necessary to display in pursuit of these desirable rewards.

At 4.30pm in the fading light of a cold December evening, the doors open and the crowd pours in. Shouldn't they know better by now? I wander off, camera over shoulder, in search of a good time. I make first for the geography room already transformed beyond all recognition into a heaving throng of noisy and excited pupils and locals.

On entry I'm reluctantly prevailed upon to part with 20p to try my hand at "Tomb Raider 2", a computer game of such devilish complexity and

requiring such digital dexterity that I'm left befuddled and humiliated within seconds. How could anyone conceivably score over 20 points (the winner was in the thousands) when faced with such sustained cartoon ferocity.

My thumbs still aching, I warily negotiate the boundaries of "The Pillow Game", which consists of children precariously balanced on a gymnasium vaulting horse and eagerly trying to knock each other off with old pillows onto a thick gym mattress. Would you like a go Mr Smith, we bet you can't beat Tom? The child abuse headlines flash before my mind's eye as I politely decline and move on.

Now "Guess the Ferret", that's

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more like it! A simple but ingenious notion, Jerry has assembled a labyrinth of drainpipes, emanating from a plastic chamber which is designed to accommodate underground pipes. The whole, fenced off by history room tables turned on their sides, to keep at bay the press of eager pupils of all ages keen to stroke the savage looking ferret, hanging from its armpits in Jerry's firm grasp. Mental note must check local educational authority's Health and Safety Regulations, Section 47, subsection 16b: emergency first aid procedures in the case of a child bitten by rodents in the event of the skin being punctured.

I part with 25p, and choose pipe number 2. Jerry confidently swings his ferret into the drainage chamber, slides across the plywood top to encase the unfortunate creature and we all stand back to await Fang's appearance at the mouth of one of the six pipes. The tension mounts. Nothing happens. Perhaps Fang is getting a little tired of the exercise and has curled up and gone to sleep in his new des-res. But then, just as we'd almost given up hope, his pointy little snout appears out of pipe number 2.

Taken aback, I'm unsure how to react. Cheers from the crowd. Mr Smith's won! Astonishing, I've never won anything before in my life and now at last this ferret has brought my relentless stream of bad form to an end. Thankfully I realise that there is no prize, other than a warm glow of achievement. I clearly have the hitherto unknown gift of ferret foresight and I make a mental note to

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But wait, is that a "Splat the Rat" pipe I see before me. My heart sinks as Jessica Stobbart presses a rounders bat into my hand and prepares to drop a small furry creature (a soft toy I hasten to add) down a short vertical drainpipe. I've never managed to splat a rat yet and my hapless attempt follows the usual pattern. Alice lets go, rat appears and falls onto floor, I swing the bat a split second later, everyone in attendance says "aw bad luck" and my ferret elation quickly melts away. I'm back in that Tomb Raider humiliation place, with young teenagers feeling politely pitiful for Mr Smith as he pathetically displays his rapidly fading faculties.

*Sedbergh Community Swifts sends best wishes for
the festive season to all swift enthusiasts*



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I swiftly pass by the "cover a £1 coin in a bucket of water" stall, another site of annual humiliation (though I strongly suspect it's just impossible), and make for the lab where there are clearly 117 sweets in the jar, the rather attractive princess doll in a purple gown must be called Antoinette and surely key number 12 opens the locker containing the tub of chocolates. I later discover, before announcing the raffle ticket winners (of which I was not one), with the help of Catherine our Gala Queen, that there were only 94 sweets in the jar, the princess goes under the most unlikely name of Ethel and key number 10 opened the lock.

But of course I knew in my heart of hearts that it was downhill all the way after the ferret triumph.

(The Sedbergh Writers' Group meet in the People's Hall at 2pm on the third Friday of the month).

RECOGNITION OF SERVICE

Neil Haworth

Further to the article "Recognition of Service" in the November issue of Lookaround...

My father never talked about his experiences in the war. Not until his death did my sisters find his personnel army papers and medals. We were both proud of him and sad that he was no longer with us to talk about it.

He suffered from malaria from his time in North Africa. He would shake uncontrollably on having an attack, perspire profusely and feel very cold. Very unpleasant to watch. He sometimes suffered from depression. While World War II was over he had battles to overcome. He died of emphysema.



FIFTY YEARS AGO

Colin Cowperthwaite

A selection of items taken from local newspapers from December 1975 and January 1976.

Dent Entertainment

On Friday, children of Dent C of E School presented an entertainment of songs, dances, plays, Nativity plays and carols before a large audience of parents and friends. An unusual item was a PE demonstration using climbing and balancing apparatus, and each age group showed their skill. This concluded with a raffle, winners of which were Mrs Cox, Mrs T. Capstick, Mrs J. Akrigg, Mrs D. Haygarth, Mrs R. Sedgwick, Mrs G. Capstick, Mr J. Cragg and Mrs S. Woof. The children had been

rehearsed by Mrs Harper, headmistress, Mrs Bush, Mrs Fallowfield and Miss Brunskill. Mrs Harper introduced the entertainment. Proceeds were for school funds.

NFU Chairman

Mr Neil Haworth is the new chairman of the Sedbergh branch of the National Farmers Union. He succeeds Mr Tom Gorst of Mutton Hall, Old Hutton, who held the position for 2 1/2 years. Mr Haworth breeds pigs at East Bridge End Farm, Garsdale, and is a partner with Richardson and Haworth. He has been a member of the Sedbergh branch since moving from Garstang some years ago. Vice-chairman is Mr John Fawcett of Uldale Farm, Ravenstonedale.

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Thieves cut Phone Wires before Raid on House

Kendal CID are searching for thieves who cut the telephone wires to a lonely house near Sedbergh, before breaking in and stealing jewellery and ornaments worth more than 1,000 pounds. Mr and Mrs Roland Shaw were asleep in bed at their detached home, The Moss, on the Sedbergh to Garsdale road, when burglars forced their way in through a window. The break-in was discovered when the family woke last Wednesday morning. Missing was all Mrs Shaw's jewellery and a number of ornaments, including a bronze figure of William Shakespeare. As Mr Shaw tried to contact the police, he found his car keys had been stolen and the telephone wires to his and a neighbour's house had been cut. The neighbour finally raised the alarm by driving to the police station. Mrs Shaw thinks her young son disturbed the thieves when he woke up at about 6.20am.

Leaving

The Rev. G. David Rhodes, who for the past 2 1/2 years has been curate-in-charge of Firbank, Killington and Howgill, has been appointed

Rector of Carleton-in-Craven. Prior to his ordination in 1970 to a curacy at St Andrew's Church, Sedbergh, Mr Rhodes, who is a chartered electrical engineer, was engaged in design work on railway electric locomotives. His wife Margaret is accomplished in the field of amateur dramatics, and has played many roles in Sedbergh Theatre productions. They have three children.

The Late Mr T.W. Inman

The funeral took place at the Parish Church of Mr Thomas William Inman, a native of Garsdale, who formerly lived at Low House. He emigrated from the dale to Canada in the early 1900's. After farming in Ontario and Alberta for 20 years, he returned to England and became horticultural manager of Bulmer's Cider Orchards in the West Country. He was also a keen geologist and archivist. Mr Inman, a bachelor, died in Herefordshire aged 92. He is survived by three nephews and three nieces. The service was conducted by the Vicar, Canon D.A. Rogers, and the organist was Mrs Mary Airey. Interment was in Garsdale Churchyard.

Junior Guild

Members of the Junior Guild heard the story of Nimrod, the shepherd, when Mr M. Dawson was the speaker at their recent meeting. Chairman of the meeting, which also included a general knowledge quiz, was Jillian Pratt. The register and minutes were read by Jennette Ferguson. Lesley Brown read the lesson, and a vote of thanks was expressed by Andrew Campbell and seconded by David Gibson.

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Cowgill Carols

Christmas celebrations were off to a good start on Sunday with the Carols by Candlelight service at St John's, Cowgill, and a good congregation appreciated the effort that is always put into the lighting of the Church for this annual service. The basic pattern of carols and readings was followed by varied music on recorder, psaltery and guitar provided by Mr and Mrs R.V. Bush, Enid Fraser and Diane Ford. Mr J. Bradbury of Burneside also sang two solos to organ accompaniment. The organist was Mr R.V. Bush and the service was conducted by the vicar, the Rev. A.J.W. Barker, assisted by Mr J.W. Warburton, the reader at the Church.

Milestone

Miss Jane Alice Udall, of 18 Castlegarth, Sedbergh, celebrated her 90th birthday recently, dispensing her home-made refreshments to friends and well-wishers who called to see her. She was educated at the old Dent Grammar School, and believes that she is probably the last person living who was educated there. After leaving school, Miss Udall helped on the family farm for many years before deciding to become a nurse. She trained as a mental nurse at Moor Hospital, Lancaster, and was there for 20 years. On her return to Dent she did some private nursing in the area, and also in Devon, until her retirement.

Garsdale Primary School

Garsdale Primary School's Christmas "do" was held just before Christmas, the main item being a play. This was based on Tolstoy's

"God is where love is", but was made up by the children themselves and entitled "Martin the Cobbler". The main part was played by Martin Bergerud. Musical items, prepared by Mr R. Bush, included a recorder group, piano and guitar soloists, group and solo vocalists. Guitar soloists were Mark Davenport, Suzanne Skill and Roland McIlldowie, pianist Sophie Adams, and vocalist Martin Garnett. A carol singing programme was organised by Miss Dilys Evans (acting headmistress), Mrs Carol Hinton, and Mrs Dorothy Tebay.

The Late Mr F.N. Kiddle

The funeral took place last week at Sedbergh Parish Church of Mr Frederick Norman Kiddle, of 24 Bainbridge Road, who died suddenly at the age of 70. Born at Whinshaw, Ribbleshead, he moved with his parents whilst still a child to Mount Pleasant, Cowgill, where his father was gamekeeper to Lord and Lady



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Bentinck. After leaving school he was employed in farm service for many years in the Buckden and Baildon areas, but after the death of his father in 1938, he returned to Cowgill and farmed Holme Hill on his own account. He was a regular worshipper at Cowgill Church, and a member of the Cowgill Institute. During the last was he was also an air raid warden, and in 1943 married the former Miss Sarah Jane Peacock, of Gawthrop, at Dent Church. He moved to Sedbergh in 1971 and was a member of the British Legion Club and the Over-Sixties Club. There was a large congregation of mourners at the service, which was conducted by the vicar, Canon D.A. Rogers, with the vicar of Dent and Cowgill, Rev.

A.J.W. Barker, also present. Interment was at Sedbergh cemetery. Mr Kiddle is survived by his wife and five cousins.

Dent WI Concert

The WI Concert was given last Thursday, Friday and Saturday evenings in the Memorial Hall. Children sang and danced to well-known songs. It was arranged by Nancy Murdoch and Kim Lyon, and included Carol and Sharon Williamson, Christine Dodd, Julie Burton, Jane Mulliner, Natalie and Cathy Lyon, Gladys Middleton and Jane Richardson. Felicity Thorpe's production of a comedy thriller followed, with some excellent acting, especially Margaret Hodgson. In the play "Goose Chase" there was some

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first rate work, with Rene Bell outstanding. Joan Richardson gave a piano solo. In the finale, children took part as well as Nancy Murdoch, Sheila Tickle, Val Mitchell, Rene Bell, Felicity Thorpe, Rene Woof, Claire Barron, Margaret Hodgson and Betty Hartley. Janet Gornall was pianist, with Judith Bush and Joan and Jacky Richardson on percussion. Mrs Richardson taught the ballet dancers and Monica Tarring was stage manager.

Secondary School

Recently it has been a busy time for pupils and staff of Sedbergh Secondary School. On Sunday the school golf tournament was held on the Appleby course and the winner was Gary Bowman, with Nicholas Woof runner-up. On Monday the school was host to 16 overseas student teachers. On Tuesday, 13 girl students went on a brief visit to London to see the World Gymnastic

championships at Wembley. The headmaster was guest at Kendal College of Further Education on Thursday, and to complete the week the St Albans based "Polyscope" Group visited the school on Friday, where they presented their unique slide show.

Gala Group

The Sedbergh Gala Group held their annual meeting recently, when the following officers were elected: chairman, Mr G.A. Steadman; vice chairman, Mr M. Dawson; treasurer, Mr G.R. Hague; assistant treasurer, Mrs N. Chamley; and auditor, Mr R. Woodhams. The office of secretary was not decided. The meeting heard a request for financial assistance from Sedbergh Fell Rescue Team, and the group allotted them 100 pounds. The same sum was donated to the annual children's party.

THE WANDERING ONE

Karen Bruce Lockhart

One day in the mid 16th century a slave earned his freedom when he discovered a pearl almost beyond price on the island of Santa Margarite in the Pearl Islands off the coast of Panama. The pearl weighed 55.95 carats, about the size of a quail's or pigeon's egg.

Following its discovery the pearl was presented to the Administrator of the Spanish colony of Panama and from there made its way to the Spanish Crown jewels under Ferdinand V and Charles V, having started on its journeys which earned it the name La Peregrina or the Wandering One.

Philip II of Spain was thought to have given the pearl to Mary I of England as a present in anticipation of their marriage, and it was thought to feature in many of her portraits, but that pearl is The Tudor Pearl. In any event after her death it reappears in Spain. There it remained for the next two centuries and was a favourite ornament of the queens of Spain. Queen Mariana died in 1696 and the pearl temporarily disappeared from sight for 100 years. Napoleon installed his brother Joseph on the throne of Spain in 1808 and the pearl reappears. Joseph was defeated by Wellington, and fled taking with him some of the Spanish royal jewels, including the pearl. It then probably went with him to the United States and thereafter to Italy. Joseph left the pearl to his nephew, the future Napoleon III. Napoleon III in his turn fled to England in exile, and sold the pearl to the Duke of Abercorn for his wife. The pearl was too heavy for its setting and on two occasions fell out, once in a sofa at Windsor Castle and once during a ball at Buckingham



Palace when it was spotted clinging to the train of lady going in to dance,

In 1969 the pearl was actioned at Sotheby's and was bought by Richard Burton for \$37,000 as a Valentine's Day gift to Elizabeth Taylor, who commissioned Cartier to create a fabulous necklace of diamonds and rubies from which the pearl hung. It featured in several of her movies. One day Elizabeth found the pearl was missing and eventually recovered it unharmed from a puppy's mouth. Following her death the pearl was again auctioned this time at Christie's in New York at a price of \$11.8 million and is now in private hands.

It is still thought to be the largest perfect drop pearl in the world.

TELLING IT LIKE IT WAS

Colin Cowperthwaite

In 2015 a book was published entitled 'Telling it like it was', which documented Dent, Sedbergh and district in living memory. Many locals people were interviewed and had their memories recorded by members of the local Oral History Society. A second volume was released six years later. I have been granted permission to reproduce some of the seasonal memories from these publications, for which I give credit the joint editors, Anthea Boulton and Veronica Whyment.

Christmas was a big occasion. Well it is for any kid, isn't it? With 'indsight now we didn't get much, but you didn't know much, did you? We used to get an apple and an orange and mebbe some plasticine and a book, and I know one year I got the

very smallest size Meccano set, well that was fantastic, fantastic! New Year's morning I used to go round letting t'New Year in, and get sixpences. Just go in and wish 'em a happy and prosperous New Year. Mrs Haygarth at Banks Farm used to give me two and sixpence which was a lot of money then. I was expected to go, you know, there were reminders before. Some of 'em you had to tek a bit of coal in, and you would get a mince pie and some ginger beer, 'appen a bit of Christmas cake.

(Dick Harrison, born 1934)

Sanker Davis used to produce the nativity play, and as I grew up a bit I was the angel Gabriel. We used to do it at midnight (on Christmas Eve) down at the Vale of Lune, that very

narrow church. Joe Sanker Davis loved gadgets and I was dressed in a sheet as the angel Gabriel to lead this procession, and he had made me a beautiful star wrapped to me head with wires down my back..... I had wings, and my hands were under this sheet holding the two wires onto a battery. It was dark of course, we just had candles, walking down that aisle, and the first king, a big boy, stood on my sheet and suddenly this star went out and I was jerked backwards! I accused two of the boys and they kept saying 'No, it wasn't me!' We went to Dent church to give the nativity play, must have been an evening, and in those days they had an organ that had to be pumped, so there was a choir boy who stood



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there and he pumped. And quite a long service as well. When we came to sing the last hymn, "While Shepherds Watched" or whatever it was, we started singing quite merrily and suddenly the organ went err, err, err, and it got weaker because he had gone to sleep! And so I set off to laugh.... and the three wise men.... well once you start laughing you can't stop, can you, especially school children! Oh! but that was the highlight of the evening! This poor little soul, he'd been there pumping, and perhaps it was the sermon!

(Jean Rochford, born 1927)

The best place to carol sing was behind the Red Lion in Sedbergh. Because they used to 'ave to come

out of the back and walk across to the toilets. And in them days it was all men that smoked, and entry was all in darkness, and we'd sing and they'd come out of the bar and all the smoke used to come out, you couldn't see owt, and they used to say "What you doing, lad?" We'd say "carol singing". And they'd give us a penny or so.... But it was that pitch black, once or twice we used to get a florin instead of a penny. We used to think, somebody's going to wonder where their money's gone!

(John Airey, born 1942)

There was none of this 'I want this' or 'I want that'. You used one of the boys' stockings because they were big stockings for footballing, so you'd

get more in. And you'd get a few nuts, probably an apple and a tangerine, a few sweets and then you got something to wear. There were no toys and things.

(David Hutchinson, born 1920)

We used to go round all the school houses carol singing with Joe Sanker Davis. I suppose Joe thought the boys would come up and put money in the bag if there were girls there, they were chiefly girls, you see, because the older boys had gone off to the army. Then one year we were invited to Gate (Dent). That was lovely! Afterwards we got tea and mince pies, and we could eat more than one!

(Jean Rochford, born 1927)

On winter nights, we used to go to visit other people, probably go after milking time, seven o'clock or so, and have supper with 'em and then sit. Parents would play dominoes or some sort of games, Ludo and things like that, and I always remember going to one house and t'door was about an inch off t'floor and t'draught used to come under, and t'farmer used to stick a topcoat underneath agin t'door to stop t'draught coming in. Another thing that used to go on in winter was pegging. If you went out sitting, you'd peg a mat. I remember me mother, she used to get the empty jute sacks from the corn, cut 'em open, and wash 'em, and then stitch 'em onto these pieces of wood, like a frame, for making mats. And then you would get what we called a wad pencil, it was a blue leaded pencil and you would draw some flowers on it or a picture, and then you would get all those old clothes

they used to collect and we used to cut 'em up into little lengths and me mother would start and peg it, all those patterns.

(Michael Bracken, born 1942)

The '47 winter, that was really bad. Dad had gone into hospital and he got a taxi up to the bottom of the lane; there was that much snow I got the horse and sled cart and managed to bring him home on that. We had four sheep overblown. Two of 'em lived and two died after we got them out, it was really bad. We went onto the fell bottom with scythes and mowed rushes t' feed the sheep, we couldn't even get straw, it was terrible!

(Myles Jackson, born 1928)

When we lived up at Littletown



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(Garsdale), t' sheep got under t' snow. Sometimes dad had t' go up an' dig an' try 'an find them 'cos they were under. It drifted, t' snow, an' dad 'ad to go and cut them out. He 'ad a big stick and he poked in t' see if he could find where there was some, or else if they're left too long they would die, an' sometimes I think 'e 'ad a dog what could tell where they were. Smell 'em, 'appen. And sometimes the neighbours would come if they 'ad got theirs out, or 'e might go to them if 'e got his out. They would ha' to count 'em and see if they'd got 'em all.

(Doris Cowperthwaite, born 1925)

In '62 and '63, when the bad winter was on, we were going up Fell End, digging snow, and they wouldn't believe us when we came 'ome at night and we 'ad photographs of it, and you couldn't imagine how much snow there was at Ravenstonedale road end. And we once took the cab

off this machine that we 'ad, and it was chucked up t' roadside, and everybody took photographs of that cab. They thought the machine was still underneath it! And every time they chucked snow to the side, the next day the wind 'ad blown it back so you'd twice as high to chuck it!

(Tommy Brooks, born 1939)

I think it started just before Christmas '62 and it went on till Easter. I was contracted on the council then to keep the snowplough on the roads with a tractor and a plough. One morning we were stopped, talking to Will Handley, and t' postman came up and said "I've never known a winter as bad as this". And Will Handley said "It was far worse than this the year I was born. I'll tell thee how bad it was. It took t' midwife that lang to see me mother, I was out sledging when she did come!"

(Michael Bracken, born 1942)

HARPER'S DAIRY

Dr John Ashton

This photograph of a gathering of local farming families captured a historic moment in the Dales tradition of community collaboration in the ritual of sheep shearing

The photograph was given to me by my oldest friend, Michael Elliot, whose grandfather, Edward Harper, had a shippoon and dairy with 24 milking cows in Rose Lane Liverpool.

Harper's dairy was just one of the many dairies and piggeries that had been established in Liverpool by farmers from the Sedbergh area towards the end of the nineteenth century and who had seen the business opportunity in feeding the urban masses.

Dales names like Harper, Capstick, and Handley were to be found across the city and in my own south Liverpool village of Woolton were to

be found two butcher shops run by the Morphet brothers. Behind one of the shops was a small abattoir which regularly slaughtered a few dozen pigs on a Saturday morning; it was Mike and my job from an early age to collect the blood from the pigs in steel buckets to make black puddings.

My grandfather, John Edward Ashton, a countryman and head gardener at the Holt shipping line family estate, was reputed to have been instrumental in establishing the abbatoir and Sedbergh descendant, Sammy Morphet, was still running a small abattoir just outside the city until quite recently.

My Harpers hailed from Garsdale where Mike's uncle Thomas Harper was still farming at Garsdale Bank in the mid-sixties when I spent the Easter of my sixth form helping out in anticipation of becoming a vet; in the



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event my life took a different turning into medicine.

Mike's auntie Joan, now into her 90's still lives in the family dairy house in Liverpool.

Both Michael's grandfather and uncle may be in the photograph taken at Kentmere Hall

Comment: For anyone who would like to follow this up there are two lengthy articles on the Cowkeepers of Liverpool in the 2002 and 2008 editions of the History Society's Sedbergh Historian with a lot of detail about the various families.

SIGHT ADVICE

Keith Birbeck

Members of the Sight Advice South Lakes [SASL] Sedbergh group met on Tues 04 Nov in the Peoples Hall for the monthly meeting. It was our pleasure to welcome Louise Braithwaite who has recently taken

up the post of Volunteer Coordinator for SASL.

Following a review of her work within the sight loss environment, Louise updated the group on recent guidance and notifications regarding sight degradation or loss. She also discussed future opportunities for local fundraising and possible collaboration events with other community groups. An enjoyable and informative talk, it was good to catch up with news from both the sight advice main office in Kendal and the other local sight advice community groups. Members warmly thanked Louise. Our next meeting Tues 02 Dec will be our Christmas lunch at the Fat Lamb. The next monthly meeting at the Peoples Hall will be Tues 06 Jan 26, 2-4pm. The group welcome new members from the Sedbergh community, if interested call Keith Birbeck 07557 871961 or Susan Harper 015396 206613.

SEDBERGH LADIES NFU (NOV)

Caroline Sandys-Clarke

For the first meeting after our summer break, on 18th September, members enjoyed a very appropriate and interesting talk for the Ladies NFU given by Sarah Harker, a director of Farmgate Vets.

Sarah was brought up on a farm between Teesdale and Swaledale. Graduating from Edinburgh University after 5 years of veterinary training Sarah joined Farmgate Vets with whom she has now been for nearly 26 years. She emphasised that Vets are there to help farmers, not only treating sick animals but also to find the best and maybe cheaper options to do so.

Prevention is obviously better than

cure and a lot of blood and faecal samples can be done 'in house' here in Sedbergh or at Junction 36 speeding up treatment. Nutrition is very important and pain relief and anti inflammatories are used much more nowadays, quite rightly in Sarah's opinion. The current averages of different stock looked after by

Farmgate Vets are 50% dairy, 20% beef, 20% sheep and 10% other. The other' being mainly dogs and cats. The latter expanded as a result of joining up with Nick Preston and Jim Bramley, here in Sedbergh.

Farmgate would like to expand the small animal side more. Sarah had many amusing tales to tell and feels that having been brought up on a



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farm she maybe understands the day to day running of such more easily than some of the younger vets.

Our October meeting was on the 21st when our speaker was Dr Chris Moss, one of 12 doctors who volunteer for BEEP. Not everyone has heard of BEEP or knows what it stands for. Originally started 30 years ago by Dr Weston, a GP in Penrith, BEEP then stood for Bringing Emergency Equipment to Penrith. Although the name hasn't changed, the purpose has and it now covers the whole of Cumbria and is entirely funded by Charity.

There are no less than 27 rescue charities in Cumbria which are all linked into each other and all dependant on the generosity of

fundraisers. So, if there is a bad road accident, farm accident or accident on the fells the initial call will go through to the call centre near Manchester and from there it is a question of who responds first or is nearest.

The air ambulance of which there are two that cover Cumbria, can often be 'scrambled' and then stood down after maybe a short time in the air if they are not needed, but this will still cost £5-10,000. There are 4 support cars apart from ambulances and other cars kitted out with emergency equipment too.

This is all very expensive but obviously very important towards saving lives. Last year the charity turned 30 and was awarded the

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KINGS AWARD comparable to the MBE.

Dr Moss is an incredibly enthusiastic speaker about the charity and his job. He trained first as an engineer before taking up medicine. He has worked on big liners crossing the Atlantic with as many as 5,000 people on board and another 1-2000 crew. The doctor on these liners is on call 24/7. Dr Moss has worked in intensive care and is currently working in AandE in Whitehaven. When not working he is on call for BEEP or out on his mountain bike! He helped to set up Westmorland Home Care 9 years ago to try and help get people out of hospital sooner with adequate support at home. I can really recommend him and his subject for any group.

On the following day, the 22nd October, we held a coffee morning to help raise funds for BEEP and raised nearly £300.

SEDBERGH LADIES NFU

Caroline Sandys-Clarke

Our group started around 60 years ago in the 1960's and we still have a handful of members who were at those early meetings. Unfortunately, we no longer have the first minutes but we do have the odd membership list.

Members of the National Farmers Union met in Sedbergh every month and at that time this meeting was typically attended by the men from the farm. The ladies felt that they were 'missing out' and so decided to set up a Sedbergh Ladies Branch with the aim of learning as well as socialising, just like the main group.

Over the years we have learnt about a wide range of local businesses and charities, not just farming related ones and heard from the public sector as well. We have had annual visits to gardens and places of interest as well as meals out. There were other local Ladies branches such as Kendal, Carnforth and Cartmel, whom we have joined with for social evenings. As with many voluntary groups membership has fluctuated, and society has changed over the years. For example, it is not now necessary to leave home to stay in touch with people, or to learn. Our membership has remained constant over the last few years, which means that almost all our current members have held the various officer posts at least once if not rather more. So reluctantly we have decided to call time as a formal group. As our membership gets older it becomes harder to find those who want to continue organising a

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programme, recording minutes and membership, do the accounts and administer the complexities of a joint bank account.

However, the silver lining is that many of us wish to keep in touch and meet informally. We may even continue to hold a coffee morning or two to raise money for local charities with our wonderful baking!

We look forward to seeing you there!

DENTDALE, HEAD TO FOOT Earthing!

Andrew Povey

Yvonne Cervetti gave an explanation of what is meant by 'Earthing' and the benefits for long term health.

Earthing is the term for harnessing the earth's natural energy and is best achieved by direct skin contact with the earth.

The human body has electricity inside it, as evidenced by medical devices like electrocardiograms. Earthing is claimed to remedy electron deficiency and electrical instability.

Our ancestors usually walked

barefoot thus maintaining contact with the earth - as do animals and, even to this day, some tribes in Africa and South America.

Yvonne showed books on the subject and noted that earthing had been studied from the mid-nineteenth century.

Lightening is an electrical discharge and this replenishes the earth's surface, with an estimated 5000 lightning strikes across the world per minute.

Yvonne is an enthusiastic and inspirational speaker; everyone enjoyed her presentation on this unusual subject.

All adult residents of Dentdale are welcome to attend our events.

Our next event on 6th February will be David Boulton speaking about The History of Dent. Look out for more details on the posters and our facebook page, 'Dentdale Head to Foot' and via the Dent with Cowgill Community Forum page. Please 'like' our page.

For further information please call .
Andrew Povey on behalf of DDHF
07881655166
poveya@btinternet.com

SEDBERGH W.I.

Moirra Folks

On a cool, overcast but dry day in October, seven members of the Walking Group drove over to Holme to start their walk going north along the canal-side from near the Primary School. At the junction with the road, which the route of the Limestone Link follows, the group proceeded east under the motorway, turning right along the A6070 for about 400 metres before crossing over to Holme Park Farm. There they took the path going east up across Holmepark Fell, which eventually joined the road at the pass between Newbiggin Craggs and Hutton Roof Craggs. That road was followed down past Rawley Copse to near Oakwood Farm where

a lane which led to a footpath that was joined to take the group down below Carwen Woods to the A6070. Crossing the road to join the 6384, a path was taken to join the canal path to return to the starting point. The day was rounded off happily with refreshments at the Ambio Café at 1818 Auctions. Many thanks to Anne Pitt for her report about the October walk.

On 30th October, the Lunch Club met at the Plough Inn, Lupton, a new venue for them and most enjoyable. (To add a personal note, it's a favourite venue for my own family – we've celebrated several birthdays and anniversaries there with excellent food and lovely surroundings).

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Sedbergh WI provided two teams in the local WI Federation November Quiz competitions, winning second place in one of the rounds: congratulations!

On November 12th, local Artist Ruth Clayton, who shares a studio at Farfield Mill with her partner, Stuart Gray, who was also present at the meeting, gave us a watercolour demonstration using sprinkled salt to give extra texture to our work showing a snowy day with a bare winter tree. It was fun and the results were surprisingly good! Thank you, Ruth and Stuart!

Book Club met at Pam Drower's home at Farfield the next day. 'The Mammy' by Brendan O'Carroll was the book under discussion,

introducing the family which stars in the TV family sitcom 'Mrs Brown's Boys'. While most of the group's criticisms were negative, because of the lavatorial nature of the dialogue, some spoke up for a kind of book which might actually encourage a non-reader to start reading books because they enjoy the dialogue form. The average score was 4/10. Pam's cakes and tea had a much higher rating! Many thanks to Pam for hosting the meeting.

There will be no December meeting in the People's Hall because we will be dining elsewhere for our WI Christmas Dinner. Our next meeting in the People's Hall committee room will be on January 14th 2026 at 7.30pm, when we will be following a journey to Antarctica and the Scotia Sea from the comfort of the committee room. Visitors and new members are always welcome. For further information, please contact our President, Louise Atkinson, on 07885 378883; or our Secretary, Lesley McCrie, on 07930 177423.

HOWGILL & FIRBANK W.I.

Bridget Postlethwaite

Sarah welcomed 8 members and 1 guest, Belinda, to our November meeting held in Howgill School Hall. The newsletter for the month was viewed and discussed, with particular attention being paid to the resolution shortlist for next year's AGM. The resolution unanimously voted for was 'to have accessible public toilet facilities to promote dignity, health and social inclusion'. 3 members had enjoyed taking part in the federation quiz which Barbon WI hosted, and

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numbers were taken for our Christmas dinner at Sedbergh Golf Club in December.

Once the business was concluded, Jacqui Robinson, one of our members, instructed us in the art of needle felting. She had come prepared with plasters and antiseptic cream, but thankfully none was needed. We all got 'very crafty' with the long needles and sheep's wool, producing a Christmas tree decoration to take home. An activity thoroughly enjoyed by everyone.

The raffle was won by Pauline, and the competition for 'a favourite Christmas bauble' was won by Bridget, with Audrey second. The evening rounded off with our usual Jacobs join.

KILLINGTON W.I.

The afternoon W.I. for the entire District

Wendy Fraser-Urquhart

It was rewarding to welcome a good turnout for our AGM in November. This is the only time of the year when we at Killington start our meeting by singing Jerusalem. I enjoy it - it takes me right back to school assemblies long ago though perhaps I'm not as pure on the top notes as I was then!

As well as being enjoyable, our meeting was very informative. Our invited speakers were officers of the Westmorland and Furness district authority; Andrew Vickers and Katharine Banks. Both are at the top of the waste and environmental



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services department. In the preceding weeks we had sent them a plethora of questions about recycling in our area. It is a subject with which we are all so much involved every day. Our speakers were both knowledgeable and enthusiastic about their subject and we learned so much about all aspects of our waste collection and disposal. There is far too much for me to report it sensibly here; do invite them to your own meetings. There are just two things that I must say 1/ none of our collected material goes to landfill 2/ if on occasions you see the bin men (sorry waste disposal operatives) putting material you have previously carefully sorted all into the lorry together, don't worry it will be resorted before it reaches its intended destination. I was both informed and reassured by what they had to say. Next summer we are planning a visit to the mechanical and biological treatment plant in Barrow where all our non-recyclable material ends up. It ends up shredded, dried and sieved before being incinerated to produce power. Katharine and Andrew were warmly thanked for their presentation.

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Then it was time for tea before we moved on to the business of the day. Birthday wishes this month went to Joan Perkins and Margaret Denton, just a tad over 21! Then onto our AGM. What a lovely year to summarise. Financial Whizz, our treasurer Margaret, showed us how we had earned and spent our money over the year, always keeping us out of the red. We thanked her for all her hard work and also had a special word of thanks for her "WISH" viz Women's Institute Supportive Husband - thank you Andy from all of us. Then our secretary's report was presented by Barbara Hartley who reminded us of all the lovely things we have done this year. We do have joint secretaries, both named Barbara (Maunder is the other one) and we love them both. Finally it was the turn of our president Susan Sharrocks to take the floor. In her usual generous way, she individually thanked all the members who have helped her throughout the year. Seconds later we rewarded her by insisting that she remains as president from least another year. Thank you Susan, we all look forward to another happy year together.

Our next meeting sees us gather at the Golf Club restaurant at 12 noon on Thursday the 4th of December for Christmas lunch. Thereafter we meet on Tuesday the 13th of January 26 at 2:00 PM when Myles Ripley will instruct us on first aid techniques....

and finally as the Reader's Digest and I like to say A HAPPY CHRISTMAS TO ALL OUR READERS.

SEDBERGH SCHOOL NEWS

Karen Bruce Lockhart

Governors have appointed Mr Robin Pyper, presently deputy Rector of Dollar Academy, to be Headmaster of the Senior School from April next year when Mr Dan Harrison becomes Executive Head of the Sedbergh Schools Group

Three new names who gave their lives in the 1st World War have recently been added to the Cloisters: James Fisher, George Windram and Humphry Maitland Thompson

Sedbergh is delighted to have been recognised as a top 3 finalist in the category of Social Mobility Champion in the 2025 School House Awards

The School listened to Stephen

Breuer give a lecture as a holocaust survivor in Hungary and described not only the broad historical events of 1944 Hungary but also the very personal details of fear, loss, separation, and the fragile moments of hope that allowed survival. The pupils lined up to shake his hand at the end

The 50 Objects continues with No 42 the foundation of Carus House with the girls from Casterton School when it closed. And No 43 the Library at the Prep School which is now the hub of the school socially and the Accelerated Reading Programme. No 44 is the building of the Hirst Centre. No 45 is the establishment of Sedbergh School Fuzhou in China which even has its own version of the




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Wilson Run. This was followed in 2023 by Sedbergh School Vietnam

On 5th November the School Bonfire and fireworks took place in a clear sky despite threatening rain

On Remembrance Sunday the morning service was held as usual above the Cloisters, just managing to avoid the rain. Wreaths were laid on behalf of the Old Sedberghians, the Army, Navy and Air Force. In the evening the Choral Society performed The Armed Man, A Mass for Peace, by Karl Jenkins in Powell Hall. This was followed by a lone piper by the Cloisters at dawn on 11th November

During the half term break the annual Classics trip went to Italy and in four days visited Rome, Pompei,

Ostia and Herculaneum.

Over 160 attended the 500th Anniversary dinner in the Long Room at Lord's cricket ground

As part of the SEDInspire programme OS Ben Dobson gave a lecture on the Amazing Ecology of Costa Rica

The debating team has reached the second round of the English Speaking Union Mace Competition

Stuart Graham, the Prep's Gardiner, ran the Prep's 7 mile Epic for 24 hours to raise money for Children in Need. This involved 123 kilometres and a total ascent of 4,250 metres (more than three times the height of Everest). The children, staff, parents and friends ran part of the way with him to encourage him

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Running

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Netball

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Equestrian

The team returned from the National Schools Equestrian Championships as National Champions after four days of competition involving 1200 horses from all over the country. Coco won the 90cm Arena Eventing and Sophie the 110cm Arena Eventing. They also were Reserve National Champion in the 80cm JWS. 20 horses and 18 riders from Yr 4 to Yr13 went to the Championships

Rugby

OS Abbie Ward scored a try in the closing moments of winning the Women's Rugby World Cup. Girls did not play rugby when she was in the School but she developed her love of the game here

On 9th November the 1st XV played Warwick at home and won 33-20

Future Events

1st XV v Millfield home 3rd

December 2.15 pm

Christmas Carol Service York

Minster 8th December 6.30 pm

End of term 12th December 2 pm

Beginning of Lent term 4th January

Rawthey Run 15th January 2 pm

King Henry Relays Coventry 28th January

Northern Inter-County Cross

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RELIGION AND POLITICS

Martin Dodds

'Don't mix Religion and Politics'.

This is a view which still surfaces from time to time, usually when church leaders, or even the joint leaders of interfaith groups, make public statements about issues of the day with which politicians are trying to deal.

It may turn up in a conversational comment by a private citizen in response to the news. It may be a thundering editorial from a newspaper or TV channel with a specific editorial policy.

Frequently this kind of response is a reaction to what is seen as 'wishy-washy liberalism', and it may include comments by some people who are

themselves genuine, committed believers.

On the other hand, when countries are ruled by religious groups or hierarchies, like Iran or Afghanistan, or even paternalist but autocratic Bhutan, some people of a broadly liberal persuasion may be critical of the imposition and control of society by a 'theocracy'. Even the constitutional Christianity of Britain is seen by some people as an unwelcome constraint on freedom of thought.

Suspicion of the involvement of religion in politics is thus not confined to particular wings of either politics or religion. It is something which may particularly irritate people who define

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themselves as not religious, or as atheists.

Does this mean that the slogan is valid? Desmond Tutu as a Christian archbishop in South Africa, was sometimes faced with the comment that the church had no business to get involved in politics. He replied with a question; 'Which Bible have you been reading?'

Tutu and many others, stand in the prophetic tradition of the Judeo-Christian experience, speaking up for the poor, the disadvantaged, the oppressed, the weak, the sick, and challenging the rich and powerful to act justly. Perhaps one of the most familiar expressions of this comes in the words of the 'Magnificat'

attributed to Mary the mother of Jesus. [In the Gospel of Luke.]

Sometimes the challenge of the prophets both in history and now, is directed at the institutional religion of the day, in its condoning or ignoring of injustice and inequality. Modern prophets may include both active people of faith and individuals who have themselves rejected conventional religion, but who recognise ethical values which go beyond the purely material.

Like most slogans 'Don't mix Politics and Religion!' seems straight forward, but is simplistic.

It fits too easily into the current era of short attention spans and sound bites in which the audience risks



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Throughout history, religion and politics have been closely related. Until the days of the so-called enlightenment, the idea that public business could somehow be separated from religion would probably have seemed both odd and dangerous. It seems to me that controversies in Western European history such as the struggles between the Holy Roman Empire and the Papacy; between Henry II and Becket, and later between Henry VIII and the Pope were chiefly about the balance of power within the relationship, not about separation.

As human knowledge increased, especially in the realm of 'natural philosophy', which eventually developed into modern science, the effort to understand meant a more detailed analytical approach to knowledge and information. The 'wholeness' of reality was necessarily broken down into different 'bits' to enable closer study within the mental capacity of the human mind.

This mental sub-division of knowledge and experience seems to have become the 'norm' more widely in modern society, not just in relation to science. It still has value in assisting understanding, but is there a danger that the essential,

integrated wholeness of reality gets overlooked?

Today we may find it easier to imagine and accept the idea that Religion and Politics can and should be each kept in their own boxes. Experience however demonstrates that neither can be effectively confined in this way.

The difficulty we face is the human tendency to manipulate, for self-serving reasons, both religion and politics. Thus, the same capacity to call on religious faith to promote justice and equity [Red Cross and Red Crescent etc] can also be used to call on faith to impose oppression and injustice. [Oppression of women in some Islamic states; the growth of so-called Christian Nationalism and associated xenophobic discrimination against migrants and other minority groups. Other forms of religious nationalism seem to be springing up in non-Christian countries too.]

At the same time, powerful politicians feel able to call on and recruit religion for political support, either at institutional level, as seems to be the case in Russia, or at emotional level, as currently seems to be happening in USA and perhaps India, for example.

In quite recent history, colonial and post-colonial governments have sometimes relied on the apparently willing co-operation of parts of various Christian institutions to achieve the deculturalisation of indigenous societies, in what we can now recognise as blatant spiritual abuse.

At this season of the year, we can also remember the political abuse in

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the story of the massacre of the innocents by King Herod, in response to his fear that a new 'religious' challenger to his position was on the way, in the person of a new child at Bethlehem. [In the Gospel of Mark.]

For good or bad, I feel the relationship between politics and religion, [probably including ethics and morality outside traditional faith structures] is too closely interwoven to be realistically disentangled.

Perhaps the slogan needs to be rephrased; -

'Don't let religion be hi-jacked by extremist politics.

Don't let politics be hi-jacked by religious extremism'

No, it is not very snappy, but I suspect the pressure for 'snappiness' is part of the underlying problem of relieving us from the responsibility to think for ourselves, so that we can be more readily 'influenced'.

Let's speak up, speak out and act for the oppressed and disadvantaged wherever and whoever they may be, whether we are people of faith, humanists, agnostics, atheists, doubters, sceptics, political activists or just ordinary people of good-will.

LIZZIE'S COLUMN

Lizzie Collinge MP

This month, I'm pleased to share updates on two very important areas of work, one right here on our local roads and another impacting the health of women across the country.

Following numerous emails to the council and productive meetings with residents in Cowgill Escape Committee (best campaign name ever!) both locally and in Parliament, I'm greatly relieved to see that work is finally beginning to repair the severe damage to a key local road caused by a landslide. The C5101 near Dent Head Viaduct has been closed since heavy rain caused damage back in November last year, leaving the road unpassable and dangerously at risk of collapse.

This landslide resulted in the carriageway being significantly undermined, and the closure and necessary diversions have caused significant hardship for many members of our community, disrupting daily life and travel. Whilst my office provided support to people in the area affected by the closure, highways officers worked with specialist contractor WSP to design and start delivering a safe, long-term solution. I will continue to press for regular updates on the progress of this essential repair work and hope to see the road safely reopened soon.

Switching focus, I'm also delighted to report on positive progress being made in healthcare. Ambulance response times for stroke and heart attack have improved by ten minutes compared to last year; we know this will save lives. And in the last year



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waiting lists have fallen for the first time in 15 years, with a 230,000 fall since the election and a 16,000 reduction in October 2025 alone. There's a lot more to do to get the NHS back on its feet but this is a good start, all made possible because of the decisions and policies of the Labour Government.

The renewed Women's Health Strategy, which we will see published next year, marks a serious effort to tackle long-standing barriers and inequalities in women's health. It was created using the direct experiences and opinions of women who contributed to our 10-Year Health Plan consultation. This isn't about top-down, one-size-fits-all mandates; it's

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about creating a system that is personalised, preventative, and crucially, one that women can feel safe and trust in.

I'm particularly pleased to see that one of the first immediate steps is the inclusion of menopause questions in NHS Health Checks for all women over 40. Menopause is a significant life event affecting millions of women, yet it's often overlooked, leaving many to struggle in silence at home and in the workplace. Bringing this into routine checks will mean better support and earlier intervention for local women, allowing them to continue living full, active lives.

We are also making progress on other crucial fronts. I have written before about my focus on maternity and other patient safety issues, and I will continue to work on these locally and nationally. I recently met with families harmed by maternity failings in Nottingham, and also with Baroness Amos to discuss the national maternity investigation, which will include Morecambe Bay Trust.

Nationally, we're listening to patients with the introduction of

Jess's Rule, which ensures local GPs think again if they see a patient three times without a diagnosis or if symptoms are worsening. This is a huge step forward for patient safety. Furthermore, we have set out an ambitious plan to eliminate cervical cancer by 2040, and we're making emergency hormonal contraception available free of charge at pharmacies. These are practical health measures which will make a lot of people's lives better.

Please don't forget, if you need my assistance you can contact my office via email on lizzi.collinge.mp@parliament.uk or leave a message on 01524 566 015. I prioritise contacts that are constituents needing direct help – if you have a query about a local or national policy I will reply as soon as I can, but you will have to wait a bit longer. Every month I get thousands of emails so I appreciate my constituents' patience as I prioritise helping those in need.



SEDBERGH PARISH COUNCIL

Janey Hassan- Clerk to SPC

This short report covers the Council's normal monthly meeting held at 7.30pm on Thursday 13 November 2025, in the Committee Room, Sedbergh People's Hall, Howgill Lane, Sedbergh.

The next scheduled meetings are 7.30pm on Thursday 11 December 2025 and 15 January 2026, in the Committee Room, Sedbergh People's Hall, Howgill Lane, Sedbergh. Meetings are generally held on the second Thursday of each month.

Casual Vacancies

There are two casual vacancies for co-option on Sedbergh Parish Council. Full details of how to apply, eligibility criteria etc, are included in this edition of the Lookaround. Please do contact the Clerk, or any existing Member of the Council, with any questions – thank you.

Westmorland and Furness Council

Members noted the current Community Governance Review Consultation being completed by WFC. Members also highlighted their concerns to Westmorland and Furness Councillor Hodgson (in attendance) in respect of the number of recent mobile phone/broadband outages.

Other matters

Various other matters were discussed, including, planning matters, resident queries/ correspondence, parish lights, and the former BT kiosk on Main Street. Finally, Members expressed thanks to former Councillor, Ian Hutt, for various lighting projects in the town

recently, including at Queen's Garden (Halloween) and the Remembrance Poppy projection on Main Street.

Members would like to wish all a Happy and Healthy Christmas and the very best for 2026

If you have any queries, or wish to contact Sedbergh Parish Council, please email at clerk@sedberghparishcouncil.gov.uk As always, Members of the public are welcome to attend meetings of the Parish Council.

Please also note that a full reference copy of all documents relating to meetings is held at 72 Main Street in the Parish Council Office, with agendas and minutes available online at www.sedberghparishcouncil.gov.uk

DEMENTIA

Alzheimers Society

7 ways to support a person with dementia in cold weather

If you're supporting somebody living with dementia, here are 7 ways to help make sure they're safe and comfortable during the colder, winter months. Winter can be a particularly difficult time for somebody living with dementia. The bad weather and colder temperatures can bring specific challenges, and can sometimes make symptoms temporarily worse. What's more, people with dementia aren't always able to communicate the fact they're cold – or they may not even recognise it themselves.

1. Make sure the person is dressed appropriately

People with dementia won't always remember to dress appropriately for colder weather, so it's important to

help make sure they're wearing the right clothes. Layers are key to keeping warm, and the best materials for maintaining body heat are cotton, wool, or fleecy fibres.

If you're going outside, remember that a lot of heat is lost through the head and neck, so make sure the person has a hat and scarf on. Gloves are also important for keeping hands warm. If it's icy or snowy, make sure the person is wearing appropriate footwear, such as non-skid boots.

2. Keep the room warm

Try to make sure any rooms that are occupied during the day are kept warm – it's a good idea to aim for around 20 degrees Celsius

As well as putting the heating on, things like draught-proofing, thermal curtains and roof insulation can help maintain a consistent temperature. It's also worth keeping a blanket within easy reach of a person with dementia, so they can grab it if they're feeling chilly. At night, a hot water bottle or electric blanket can help keep the bed warm.

Cost of living support for people affected by dementia. You might be worried about how rising living costs will impact your finances if you live with dementia, or care for someone with the condition. There is help and support available.

3. Encourage regular movement

Keeping active can help to boost circulation and help keep someone

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with dementia warm. It's a good idea to encourage the person to move around at least once an hour.

If walking is difficult or extreme weather conditions make it hard to go outside, simply getting the person with dementia to move their arms and legs, or wiggling their toes can be helpful.

There are more ideas for exercises on our physical activity page.

4. Make the most of natural daylight

Decreased sunlight can cause someone with dementia to feel increased anxiety, confusion, and even depression during the winter.

You can help by making sure they're exposed to natural daylight when possible. Get outside when you

can – a quick walk around the block or even just sitting outside in the garden for a few minutes can do wonders.

At home, make sure curtains are open during the day to let in as much light as possible. You could also position the furniture so that the person with dementia is sitting near a window. As natural light starts to fade, make sure lights and lamps are turned on.

5. Stick to a routine

A big change in routine can cause someone with dementia to become confused or agitated.

If you do have to make changes to someone's routine in winter – for example, changing nap times or daily walks due to limited daylight – try to

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do them slowly and gradually.

6. Be careful in icy or snowy weather

Perception issues can make it difficult for someone with dementia to see icy patches on a pavement or understand that snow can make a surface extra slippery.

If you're out for a walk in icy or snowy conditions, make sure you're supporting the person with dementia carefully. Encourage them to take smaller steps and walk more slowly than usual.

7. Eat and drink regularly

Keeping warm uses up a lot of energy, and a warm house can increase the risk of dehydration. It's important to make sure someone with dementia is eating regular meals and drinking enough fluid during the winter.

Snacking throughout the day can help keep energy levels up, and warm drinks can help keep them at a comfortable temperature. They should avoid drinking alcohol as it makes you feel warm, but actually draws important heat away from vital organs.

USING FOOD BANKS

Citizen's advice

I'm stressed about being able to afford food for my family as the colder months set in. We will be spending more on heating, and we're barely making it through as it is. Can I use a food bank if I need to?

You're not alone - Citizens Advice helps lots of people in this position. Food banks are community organisations, and you'll usually need a referral before you can use one.

Contact South Lakes Citizens Advice and ask them to refer you. They'll make an appointment for you to discuss your situation with an adviser, who will check you're eligible. If you are, they will make the relevant referral. They can also check if you are eligible for any benefits, assist with budgeting, and tell you about other local help you could get. You can also ask for a referral from another organisation, for example your GP or social worker.

When you visit the food bank, let them know if you have any allergies or dietary requirements. You'll get a food parcel, and it will usually contain enough food for three days, and you might also get essential toiletries.

If you live in a rural area or are sick or disabled, the food bank might be able to deliver your parcel - contact

Sedbergh and District Lookaround

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them to ask. If the food bank is run by a religious group, they'll still help you if you don't belong to that group.

Free, confidential advice and help is available from South Lakes Citizens Advice on any aspect of debt, consumer problems, benefits, housing, employment or any other problems. How to access:

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PERSONAL MESSAGES

CHRISTINE WOOD

Invites all her friends to an 'At Home' on Wed 17th December 2pm – 5pm to celebrate her 90th Birthday. No presents please.
Kings Court

VOLUNTARY SOCIAL CAR SCHEME

The scheme will not operate between 22nd December and 2nd January due to holiday commitments.

BOOK TOWN QUIZ ANSWERS

1. Anthony Burgess
2. Anne Frank
3. The Grapes of Wrath – John Steinbeck
4. Noël Coward
5. Observer's Books
6. South Africa
7. Margaret Atwood
8. (George) Bradshaw
9. Adam Dalgleish – P D James
10. Lyrical Ballads
11. Richard Dawkins
12. The House at Pooh Corner

EDITORIAL

Well, that was 2025. We started with a subsidised bus, a fish and chip shop and a chemist, and nearly ended without them all. The chemist coming back to life is a very positive step. As was the arrival of the Mug Story. Well done to them! Who knows what will happen with the buses.

And Lookaround, at one point we thought that this might have been our last year, but we are still here, and right now our finances are stable and we should be viable for the foreseeable future. However we depend on our readership and advertisers, so please keep taking Lookaround, and advertising. We need you.

Happy Christmas everyone and have a great New Year! *Ed.*

Christmas Messages

WILLIAM AND MARY AND FAMILY

To everyone, who over the last few weeks, have supported us with prayers, encouragement and love we give our sincere and heartfelt thanks. We have been overwhelmed by the kindness we have been shown, and wish you all a Happy Christmas and a peaceful and healthy New Year. Thank you and God Bless you all.

=====

MITCH AND MEL (MITCHELL)

Send SEASONS' GREETINGS to all family and friends and clients. All the best wishes for 2026

=====

SANDRA AND STEVE LONGLANDS

Would like to wish their friends and family a smashing Christmas and a Happy and Healthy 2026.

=====

DAWSON-EASTHAM

Joe and Judith wish all friends, former neighbours and customers in Sedbergh, Dent and District a Happy Christmas and Best Wishes for the New Year.

=====

CHRISTINE WOOD

Wishes all her friends a very Happy Christmas and a good New Year to follow.

=====

GEORGINA DEVINE

Would like to wish a very Happy Christmas and New Year to all her friends in Sedbergh, Garsdale and Dent, and everywhere else!

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Age UK North Cumbria
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Copeland Age & Advice Service
01946 552166

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www.cumbriafoundation.org/fund/winter-warmth-fund-individuals



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LOOKAROUND DETAILS

LOOKAROUND INFORMATION

The Sedbergh & District 'Lookaround' is edited, published and distributed monthly by the 'Lookaround' editorial team of volunteers and printed by Stramongate Press, Kendal.

The content of 'Lookaround' does not reflect the views of the editors and whilst every effort is made to ensure that information is correct, the editors cannot accept any responsibility for inconvenience caused through errors or omissions; if there is an error in your article or advert, please contact the editor as soon as possible.

The current issue is available from Sedbergh Tourist Information Centre, Rycrofts, Sedbergh Post Office and Spar. Also from Dent Stores, the Barbon Churchmouse and by post (please address enquiries to the editor). Back copies are available to read at the History Society Archive at 72 Main Street or online at www.lookaround.org

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Articles and reports are inserted for free and photographs may be included (depending on space). Articles should ideally be submitted as a word attachment to an email addressed to the editor rather than as

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The font should be 'Arial', 11point and the piece should be single spaced and with as few 'hard returns' or paragraphs as possible. This is to make the job of proofing and formatting easier and also to ensure that all articles have the same impact and appearance.

Please put the title on the first line at the top of the article and the author's name on the second line. If you include images with your article please indicate where you feel they would be best placed. Conforming to these requests very much helps the proofreaders/formatters in getting your article to the compiler for printing in good time.

We are very happy to accept handwritten or typed pieces, if handwritten please use capitals to help us transcribe the article accurately and again, please place the title on the first line and the author's name on the second line.

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We are published on the 1st of every month (except January).

February to November is printed black ink on white. The December/January issue may be in full colour. All copies have a full colour cover by

a local photographer.

The closing date for everything is 15th of every month.

ADVERTISING

Please see page 4 for the main points on advertising in Lookaround. Further details can be found below.

PERSONAL MESSAGES

These are £1 each & are for sending Good Wishes, Thank You's, Birthday Greetings, Anniversaries & any other celebration or congratulation. You may also sell personal items but not on a business basis, & also make an appeal for wanted items.

Details with respect to people Passing Away are inserted for free.

Please ensure your submission is legible. We want to make sure we publish what you want us to publish.

GROUPS AND ORGANISATIONS

Any organisation that charges an admission, sells items or requires a donation from the public for anything at their event & wishes to include details in *The Lookaround*, are requested to place an Advert with us. This can be supported by text which cannot all be included in the advert. Any report *after* the Event is free. The request for payment for an Advert is to assist with financing *The Lookaround* which has a large printing expense every month. We feel that the Advertising Rates are very reasonable (for the last 18 years). All Adverts for Events automatically have the details entered into the Diary Page at the rear of *The Lookaround*. If organisations do not wish to Advertise with us, details of the Event will still appear on the Diary Page, but no text will be inserted.

BUSINESSES

Adverts for the Rent or Sale of property are not Personals & can only be included as a boxed Advert.

If you are a new advertiser in Lookaround & you order 3 or more adverts, you will receive one free advert & can also include some text explaining who you are, what you are, where you are, etc (which can not all go into an advert) up to about 550 words for free.

If you have more than 3 months of advertising, we will automatically send a renewal reminder should you wish to continue. If you order 10 months, we give you one free (making one whole year). See page 4 for information on how to pay.

CHILDREN'S BIRTHDAYS

Children's Birthdays are included free on the Birthday Page. Please send us the date, name and age of your child before the submission date (15th of the month) of the issue when the birthday should appear.

COVER PICTURES

If you have any pictures to go onto the cover of Lookaround, please send a high definition copy with the location and your name, and you will be credited. If the interest of the picture is in the centre it will be difficult to use as the centre is on the spine. Each half of the picture needs to work as one cover (back is the left hand side, front is the right).

LOOKAROUND BY POST

We will post Lookaround to you in the UK at a cost of £30.00 for an Annual Subscription, or anywhere in the world for £6.00 per issue.

CONTACT DETAILS

See page 4.

Lookaround Editorial Group

PUZZLE SOLUTIONS

9	6	2	4	1	7	3	5	8
8	3	7	9	2	5	4	1	6
5	4	1	8	3	6	7	9	2
3	7	8	1	6	9	2	4	5
2	1	5	3	4	8	9	6	7
6	9	4	7	5	2	1	8	3
7	8	3	6	9	1	5	2	4
4	5	9	2	8	3	6	7	1
1	2	6	5	7	4	8	3	9

7	9	8	6	1	5	4	3	2
5	2	4	9	7	3	1	6	8
1	3	6	8	2	4	7	9	5
4	5	2	3	8	9	6	7	1
6	1	7	4	5	2	3	8	9
9	8	3	1	6	7	5	2	4
2	7	9	5	3	1	8	4	6
8	4	5	7	9	6	2	1	3
3	6	1	2	4	8	9	5	7

PEOPLES' HALL HIRE RATES

From 1 st July 2022	Main Hall Fees					Committee Room Fees			
Time From	07:00	09:00	13:00	17:00	19:00	09:00	13:00	17:00	19:00
Time To	09:00	13:00	17:00	19:00	01:00 (Sun 23:45)	13:00	17:00	19:00	01:00 (Sun 23:45)
Rate 1	£12.00	£24.00	£24.00	£18.00	£45.00	£18.00	£18.00	£12.00	£18.00
Rate 2	£18.00	£36.00	£36.00	£27.00	£67.50	£27.00	£27.00	£18.00	£27.00
Rate 3	£24.00	£48.00	£48.00	£36.00	£90.00	£36.00	£36.00	£24.00	£36.00
	Changing Room A Fees					Changing Room B Fees			
Rate 1	£9.00	£17.50	£17.50	£12.50	£17.50	£12.50	£12.50	£10.50	£12.50
Rate 2	£13.50	£26.50	£26.50	£19.50	£26.50	£19.50	£19.50	£16.00	£19.50
Rate 3	£18.00	£35.00	£35.00	£25.00	£35.00	£25.00	£25.00	£21.00	£25.00
Alcohol Licence: £30.00 + £100 damage deposit									
Rate 1	Private individuals, community groups, clubs etc based in: LA10, Firbank, Howgill or Killington								
Rate 2	Businesses based in LA10, Firbank, Howgill or Killington OR Private individuals, community groups, clubs etc not in Rate 1								
Rate 3	Businesses outside local area OR Statutory organisations								

SOME WALKS AROUND SEDBERGH

WINDER 3.4 miles, 1150 ft, 1.5-2.5 hrs

Sedbergh's own little Matterhorn with great views of the surrounding fells and dales. *(Walk 1)*

THE CALF 8 miles 2600ft 4-5 hrs

A bracing ridge walk over Arant Haw and Calders to the highest point in the Howgills. *(Walk 1)*

FARFIELD MILL 3.7-4.4 miles, 2-3 hrs

Fairly flat walk partly by the riverside, with the added advantage of the Farfield Café half way around. *(Walk 2)*

AKAY WOODS 2.3 miles 1 - 1.5 hrs

Lovely riverside stretches, past the restored Pepperpot, then through woods above the river, with vestigial remains of Akay House. *(Walk 3)*

SEDBERGH SCHOOL 45 mins

A stroll to see the sights of Sedbergh School *(Walk 4)*.

FELL WALL 2.2 miles 1 - 1.3 hrs

Elevated promenade above Sedbergh Town, not as energetic as going to Winder top, but still out onto the edge of the open country. *(Walk 6)*

BRIGGFLATTS 4.2 miles 2- 3 hrs.

Along the Rawthey to the peaceful and historic Quaker Meeting House, then back through the fields. *(Walk 7)*

DENT AND BACK 11.5 miles 1500 ft 4-5 hrs

Across the wild (and possibly wet) Long Moor to Dent then back by Dentdale and the River Dee. *(Walk 8)*

CAUTLEY SPOUT FROM CROSS KEYS 2.5 miles 1 - 1.5 hrs

A stroll across open country to the bottom of Cautley Spout. Some would say this is the second highest waterfall in Britain. *(Walk 9)*

CAUTLEY SPOUT AND BACK 10 miles 3150 feet 4.5 - 6.5 hours

Gorgeous walk up the dale to the Spout, with a return over the tops for the adventurous. *(Walk 9)*

MILLTHROP AND ABBOT HOLME 5.1 miles

920ft 2.5 - 3 hours. Up over Frostrow, down into Dentdale, to follow the Dee past the golf course, and back to Sedbergh. *(Walk 10)*

DALES WAY AND CRAGGSTONES. 7.5 miles

1165 ft 3 - 4 hrs. Follow the Dales Way beside the Rawthey and the Lune, then ascend past the waterfalls in Craggstones Wood, before a final stroll across the base of Winder. *(Walk 11)*

For further details of these numbered walks see the Sedbergh Town website. Leaflets describing the walks can also be obtained from Sedbergh Tourist Information Centre for 50p.

PLACES OF INTEREST TO VISIT IN THE AREA

Bowling Green, Queens Gardens
Bruce Loch Nature Area, Busk Lane
Cautley Spout, A683 towards Kirkby Stephen
Community Office, 72 Main Street
Community Orchard, Vicarage Lane
Cornerstone Community Church, New Street
Cumbria Wildlife Trust, Community Office
Dent Heritage Centre, Laning, Dent *
Farfield Mill, A684 Garsdale Road
Friends Quaker Meeting House, Brigflatts
George Fox's Quaker Pulpit, Firbank
Golf Club, Catholes, Sedbergh *
Information Centre, 72 Main Street
History Society, Community Office
Holy Trinity Church, Howgill
Jubilee Wood Nature Area, Castlehaw Lane
Langstone Fell, A684 Garsdale Foot
Motte & Bailey Castle, Castlehaw Lane
Pepperpot Folly, Busk Lane
Picnic Site, Ghyllas, Cautley Road
Picnic Site, Settlebeck New Bridge
Play Ground, Dent Village
Play Ground, People's Hall
Play Ground, Maryfell
Queen's Gardens, Station Road
St. Andrew's Church, Dent
St. Andrew's Church, Main Street, Sedbergh
St. Gregory's Church, Vale of Lune
St. John's Church, Cowgill
St. John's Church, Firbank
St. John's Church, Garsdale
St. Mark's Church, Cautley
Sedbergh Embroidery, StAS
Tennis Courts, Guldrey Lane *
Winder Fell, above Sedbergh
* = Entry Fee Applicable

DIARY OF EVENTS

Dates are held up to 24/11/2026
 Dates in **BOLD** are start & finish events.
 Numbers in Brackets indicate Advert/Article on a Page.
 Month in Bracket relates to issue that details last
 appeared.

DECEMBER 2025

01	1000	Police Drop In (29)	72 Main St
03	1630	Carols at Ribbleshead (11)	Station In
03	1800	Late Night Opening (5,7,8)	Sedbergh
04	1200	WIK Christmas Lunch (59)	Golf Club
05	1230	Dent Folk Carols Festival (11)	Sun Inn
06		Dentdale Head to Foot Lunch	DMH
06	1800	Sedbergh Town Band Xmas Concert (8,1)	StAS
07	1800	Free Singalong Carols	St Mary's
08		Dent Folk Carols Festival (11)	Sun Inn
09		WIK - Christmas Lunch	TBA
09	1930	Domino Drive	FCH
10		WIS Christmas dinner	TBA
10	1900	Sing Joyfully Xmas concert	St Mary's
10	1930	Sedbergh YFC Domino Drive (Nov)	PH
11	1930	Sedbergh Parish Council (70)	PH
12		Term Ends (Oct)	SS
13		Lakeland Voices (11)	FM
13	1400	Sedbergh Orchestra Concert (9)	StAS
13	1400	WIK - First Aid (59)	PH
14	1500	Levens Choir Concert (12,12)	St Mary's
14	1500	Trott Celebration Conc. (14)	Thornley S
20	1000	Dent Methodist Coffee Morning (May)	DMC
21	1030	Methodist Christmas Celebration	DMC
23		Town Band Carolling (8)	Sedbergh
25	1330	Christmas Dinner	WHC

JANUARY 2026

04		Beginning of Term (61)	SS
13	1930	Domino Drive	FCH
14	1100	PMRGCA support group	FM
14	1930	WIS Antarctica and Scotia Sea (57)	PH

15	1400	Rawthey Run (61)	SS
15	1930	Sedbergh Parish Council (70)	PH
24	1930	The Penguin Lessons (Cinema) (Nov)	PH
25	1900	Burns Night Ceilidh (17)	PH
27	1730	Protecting Birds of Prey	online

FEBRUARY 2026

06		DDHF - History of Dent (56)	TBA
10	1930	Domino Drive	FCH
11	930	Christian Aid Coffee Morning	StAS
11	1930	WIS St Johns Hospice	PH
12		Health Centre closed - staff trg	MC

MARCH 2026

04	1100	PMRGCA support group	FM
10	1930	Domino Drive	FCH
11	1930	WIS AGM	PH
12		Health Centre closed - staff trg	TBA
15		Wilson Run (61)	SS
15	1400	Wilson Run	SS
21	1300	Sedbergh Spring Show (16)	PH

APRIL 2026

16		Health Centre closed - staff trg	TBA
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MAY 2026

13		Health Centre closed - staff trg	TBA
24		Town Twinning celebrations	TBA

All entries in the Diary are free and helps other organisations to make their own plans for events. If you have it in your Diary, please put it in ours.

JOSS LANE & LOFTUS HILL CAR PARKING CHARGES CARS & CARS WITH TRAILERS

1 hour = £1.50

4 hours = £5.00

2 hours = £2.70

All day (9 hours) = £7.00

3 hours = £3.90

Payable all days 9am - 6pm

Maximum stay = 24 hours

Annual Resident Permit = £70

Permit available from the Information Centre only,
 renewable annually on 1st September.

	DIARY KEY
AS	Art Society
BC	Sedbergh Bowling Club
BF	Brigflatts
BVH	Barbon Village Hall
CCCN	Cornerstone Community Church, New St
CM	Coffee Morning
CWT	Cumbria Wildlife Trust
DCMH	Dales Countryside Museum, Hawes
DCP	Dent Car Park
DCS	Dentdale Chapel Schoolroom
DHTF	Dentdale, Head to Foot
DMH	Dent Memorial Hall
DMC	Dent Methodist Chapel
FCH	Firbank Church Hall
FM	Farfield Mill
GC	Golf Club
GH	Gladstone House
GVH	Garsdale Village Hall
HS	History Society
HVH	Howgill Village Hall
HTH	Holy Trinity Howgill
JLCP	Joss Lane Car Park
KL	Kirkby Lonsdale
KPH	Killington Parish Hall
L	Library, Main Street
LHCP	Loftus Hill Car Park
MC	Medical Centre
MCD	Meditation Centre, Dent
PH	People's Hall
QG	Queens Gardens
RFC	Rugby Football Club
RR	Rawthey Room, 72 Main Street
SASL	Sight Advice South Lakeland
SCC	Sedbergh Cricket Club
StAS	St Andrew's Church, Sedbergh
StAD	St Andrew's Church, Dent
StJCC	St Johns Church, Cowgill
StJCG	St Johns Church, Garsdale
StMC	St Mark's Church, Cautley
SIC	Sedbergh Information Centre, 72 Main St
SPS	Sedbergh Primary School
SS	Sedbergh School
SSAT	Settlebeck School Academy Trust
SSL	Sedbergh School Library
STC	Sedbergh Tennis Courts
TBA	To Be Announced
TR	Thirsty Rambler
WA	Wensleydale Arts
WHC	White Hart Club
WID	Women's Institute, Dentdale
WIHF	Women's Institute, Howgill & Firbank
WIK	Women's Institute, Killington
WIS	Women's Institute, Sedbergh

EAT AND DRINK IN SEDBERGH

BLACK BULL HOTEL.

MAIN STREET - 015396 20264

Nationally recognised and award winning restaurant. Also has 'The Meadow' outdoor bar and kitchen in the garden for sunny days and evenings.

DALESMAN COUNTRY INN

MAIN STREET - 015396 21183

The restaurant serves modern 'traditional' cuisine using local producers. There's a welcoming fire and plenty of real ales, lagers and gins in the bar.

HADDOCK PADDOCK

MAIN STREET

Closed due to fire damage

HALF AND HALF

MAIN STREET

Bar with sofas and a good fire, or window seats if you fancy watching the world go by.

THE RED LION

FINKLE STREET - 015396 20433

A lovely traditional pub serving local ales and wholesome food. Just what you need when you've come down from the fells.

SEDBERGH GOLF CLUB

CATHOLES, DENT ROAD - 015396 21551

Open to all for well cooked classic food.

SEDBERGH PIZZA

MAIN STREET - 015396 28262

Takeaway with some seating serving good pizzas, burgers, kebabs. Open late.

SMATTS DUO

MAIN STREET - 015396 20552

If you fancy a full English breakfast, lunch or afternoon tea this is the place for you.

THE MUG STORY

MAIN STREET

Good coffee, tempting cakes, sandwiches, croissants and excellent artisan bread. A great place to meet up.

THIRSTY RAMBLER

MAIN STREET - 07874 838816

Thirsty after rambling? This micro bar is the place for a relaxing drink with good company.

THE TEA ROOM AT FARFIELD MILL

HAWES RD - 015396 21958

catering@farfieldmill.org

Walk to the Mill and have lunch or tea in the café. Sit outside by the river on a fine day.

GROUPS AND ORGANISATIONS

Age UK South Lakeland -----	Helpline - 030 300 30003
Allotments Association - Dent -----	Mr Colin Brunold - 07762 217385
Allotments Association - Sedbergh -----	Mr Jim Atkins - 015396 20031
Angling Association -----	Mr Wright - 015396 25533
Art Society - Sedbergh -----	Mrs Alison - jen.alison10@gmail.com
Audio Lookaround -----	Rosemary Handley - rosemaryahandley@hotmail.co.uk
Babies & Toddler Group - Dent -----	Sarah Woof - 015396 25212
Badminton Club - Sedbergh -----	David Wheatley - 07816 437500
Beekeepers Association -----	Rosemary Hartley - 07596 117035
Bell Ringers (StAS) -----	Mrs Sharrocks - 015396 20754
Book Group -----	Mrs J.E. Dodds - 015396 20308
Bowling Club - Sedbergh -----	Phil Johns - 07807 909860
Bridge Club -----	Mr Alison - 015398 24666
Carer Support South Lakes Office -----	Kendal - 01539 815970
Christian Aid -----	Mrs Thompson - 015396 22023
Citizens Advice Bureau -----	Kendal - 0808 2787 984
Community Corner - Dent -----	Sarah Woof - 015396 25212
Community Officer -----	See Public Information
Community Orchard Group -----	Mrs Parratt - 07443 580 960
Community Swifts (Sedbergh) -----	Mrs Hoare - 01539 824043
Community Trust -----	Ann Parrat - parrattann@gmail.com
Cornerstone Community Church -----	William Allen - 015396 20194
Crickets Club - Sedbergh -----	Kris Baldock - 07730 659413
Dent Meditation Centre -----	Bel Charlesworth - 07775 920079
Dent Memorial Hall -----	Mrs McClurg - 07855 102930 / annemcclurg@btinternet.com
Dentdale Choir -----	John Feltham - 015396 25689 / feltham.john@btinternet.com
Dentdale Head to Foot -----	Mr Steele - 015396 25054
Dignity in Dementia -----	Diane Smillie - 07771 682378
Dog Training - Sedbergh -----	Mrs Robertshaw - 015396 20316
Farfield Mill - Art Craft Heritage -----	015396 21958 / reception@farfieldmill.org
Firbank Church Hall -----	Stephen Troughton - 015396 21109
First Responders - Dent -----	See Public Information
First Responders - Sedbergh -----	See Public Information
Football Club Junior - Sedbergh -----	Rebecca Parkin (Chair) - 015396 20585 / beccystaley@btinternet.com
Football Club Senior - Sedbergh -----	Mr Parkin - 015396 20585
Friends of Farfield Mill -----	friends@farfieldmill.org
Friends of Settle and Carlisle Line -----	john.carey@settle-carlisle.com
Garsdale Village Hall -----	Mrs Labbate - 015396 22114/07814 378758 / rhlabbate@gmail.com
Getting Together -----	Sarah Woof - 015396 25212
Gladstone Community Group -----	Janey Hassam - 07966 134554
Golf Club -----	Mr Gardner - 015396 21551
Good Companions - Dent -----	Sarah Woof - 015396 25212
Grief Share -----	Duty Team Member - 07498 870267
History Society -----	Karen Bruce Lockhart - 015396 34603
Howgill Harriers -----	admin@howgillharriers.co.uk
Howgill Village Hall -----	Gareth Marshall - 07801 276233
Howgill's Harmony -----	Mr Burbidge - 015396 21166
Ignite Youth Club -----	Joe Gorst - 07964 830473 / joe.gorsty24@gmail.com
Killington Parish Hall -----	John Harrison - 07810 140996 / johnharrison249@gmail.com
Killington Sailing Association -----	Myles Ripley - mylesripley@btinternet.com
Ladies National Farmers Union -----	Caroline Sandys-Clarke - 015396 21246
Liberal Democrats -----	TBA
Little People -----	Emma Brown - 07855 620018 / emmabrown05@hotmail.co.uk
Meals On Wheels -----	Colin Cowperthwaite - 07961 925003
Messy Church -----	Rev'd Andy Burgess - 015396 20018

GROUPS AND ORGANISATIONS (CONT)

Orchestra - Sedbergh -----	Nicola Cann - 07884 391587 / drnicolacann@outlook.com
Over 60's Swimming Group -----	Sedberghswimmingclub@gmail.com
Parent Support Group -----	Mrs Goad - 015396 20402
Parish Council - Dent -----	Scott Thornley - 07368 455353
Parish Council - Garsdale -----	Clerk - clerk@garsdaleparishcouncil.gov.uk
Parish Council - Sedbergh -----	Janey Hassam - 07966 134554
People's Gym -----	membership@sedberghgym.club
People's Hall -----	Steve Longlands - 015369 20885
Pepperpot Club - Sedbergh -----	Nicola Cann - 07884 391587 / drnicolacann@outlook.com
Playground - Sedbergh -----	Janey Hassam - 015396 20125
Playgroup - Sedbergh -----	07785 743837 / sedberghplaygroup@yahoo.com
Playing Field - Sedbergh -----	Steve Longlands - 01536 20885
PMR/GCA support Group -----	0300 111 5090 / kendal@pmrgca.org.uk
Poetry Club* -----	booktown@sedbergh.org.uk
Red Squirrel Group - Sedbergh -----	sedberghredsquirrels100@gmail.com
Royal British Legion -----	Keith Birbeck - 07557 871961 / keithbirbeck@gmail.com
Schools - Dent Primary -----	015396 25259
Schools - Dent Primary - Friends of -----	015396 25259
Schools - Sedbergh Primary -----	015396 20510
Schools - Sedbergh School -----	015396 20303
Schools - Settlebeck -----	015396 20383
Scouts -----	Bill Mawdsley - 07989 201481
Scouts - Beavers -----	Bill Mawdsley - 07989 201481
Scouts - Cubs -----	Bill Mawdsley - 07989 201481
Sedbergh Book Town -----	booktown@sedbergh.org.uk
Sedbergh Community Tree Group -----	Evelyn Pardoe - plantmoretrees3@gmail.com
Sedbergh Environmental Group -----	sedberghcomarket@greencobweb.co.uk
Sedbergh Ladies Friendship Group -----	Jo Birkbeck - 07769 908663
Sedbergh Songsters -----	TBA
Sedbergh United Charities -----	John Sykes - 07786 384917 / jmsykes100@gmail.com
Senior Golfers -----	Mr Braddon - 0330 1138850
Shooting Club - Sedbergh -----	Richard Martin - 07884 559829
Sight Advice South Lakeland -----	Miss Harper - 015396 20613
Sing Joyfully! (Kirkby Lonsdale) -----	Anastasia Micklethwaite - 07952 601568
Spellbound Theatre -----	Facebook: Spellbound Theatre
Squash Club -----	John Bannister - 07877 301088
Swimming Club -----	Sedberghswimmingclub@gmail.com
Tennis Club -----	Tennis Club - 07974 330492 / gbot4aud@hotmail.com
Town Band - Sedbergh -----	Sarah Waters - 015396 20457
Town Twinning Group -----	Garth Steadman - 07796 164066
Transport Users Group -----	Ed Welti - sd.transportusers@gmail.com
Voluntary Car Scheme -----	Myles Ripley - 07880 161648 / vscssedbergh@gmail.com
Westmorland Gazette Entries -----	Ed Welti - 07854 103377
White Hart Sports and Social Club -----	The Committee - 015396 20773
Women's Institute - Dentdale -----	Mrs Smith - 015396 25607
Women's Institute - Howgill -----	Mrs Hoggarth - 01539 824663
Women's Institute - Killington -----	Mrs Sharrocks - 015396 20754
Women's Institute - Sedbergh -----	Louise Atkinson - 07855 378883
Young Farmers - Sedbergh -----	Club Secretary - sedberghyfc@hotmail.com

*Groups are currently being updated—TBAs will be removed in the coming editions.
If you would like to add or update your group please let us know.
New groups are marked with an asterisk *.*



BED & BREAKFAST

Proprietor	Address	Phone (015396)
Mrs J Postlethwaite	Bramaskew Farm, Howgill, Sedbergh LA10 5HX (2013/09) 21529 1D(ES); 1T(ES); CH; TV; P; NP; Di; VB; EM; CW e-mail:- stay@drawellcottage.co.uk	
	The Cross Keys, Cautley, Sedbergh LA10 5NE (2022/08) 20284 1T(ES), 1D(ES) NS, CH, L e-mail: crosskeyscautley1@outlook.com	

CAMPING, CARAVANNING & SELF-CATERING

Mrs S Capp	Scrogg House Farm Cottages, Cautley Road, Sedbergh LA10 5LN 34032 Boskins: <i>Sleeps 4; D/T(S King); ES x 2; L; P; CH; DW; DR; WiFi</i> Speight Cottage: <i>Sleeps 2; D(King); L; P; DR; CH; WiFi; Hot Tub</i> e-mail: sam@thecapps.co.uk website: www.scrogghouse.farm	
Borrett Barn Caravan, Marthwaite, Sedbergh (2018/04)	<i>Sleeps 4 people; D; T; CH; L; P; NS</i>	21175
Borrett Barn Flat, Marthwaite, Sedbergh (2018/04)	<i>Sleeps 4 people; D; T; CH; L; P; NS</i>	21175
Ann Newbold 45845	The Pele Tower, Killington Hall, Killington, LA6 2HA (2019/11) <i>Luxury Self Catering Sleeps 2-4 people 2D ES /1D 1T ES; CH; L; TV; NP; NC</i> e-mail: hello@killingtontower.co.uk website: www.killingtontower.co.uk	
The Roost at Bowersyke, Killington, LA10 5EW	<i>Sleeps 2 people 1D CH L TV P NS NP NC</i> e-mail: booking@theroostcottage.co.uk website: www.theroostcottage.co.uk	07927 295262

KEY

F = Family Rm; D = Double Rm; S = Single Rm; T = Twin Rm; ES = En Suite; PB = Private Bathroom CH = Central Heating; L = Lounge; TV = TV in all Rooms; TVL = TV Lounge; P = Parking; DA = Disabled Access; NS(B) = No Smoking (Bedrooms); NP(*) = No Pets (* by arrangement); DW = Dogs Welcome; DR = Drying Room; Di = Dinners; VB = Vegetarian Breakfast; CB = Celiac Breakfast; EM = Evening Meal;; NC = No Children; CW = Children Welcome; TL = Table Licence; DFB = Dairy Free Breakfast

BUS SERVICES

NOTE.

Westmorland and Furness Council have renamed the bus routes which cover Sedbergh to Kendal via Oxenholme as the S1 route. However they include extensions to Kirkby Stephen and Dent on different days.

MONDAY AND FRIDAY the service is from Sedbergh Maryfell to Kendal Bus Station and return. This service is run by Westmorland and Furness.

TUESDAY AND THURSDAY the service is from Kirkby Stephen CoOp to Kendal Morrisons and return. This service is run by Western Dales Bus as a commercial operation.

WEDNESDAY the service is from Dent Village to Kendal Morrisons and return. This service is run by Western Dales Bus as a commercial operation.

SATURDAY the service is from Dent Station to Kendal Morrisons and return. This service is run by Western Dales Bus as a commercial operation.

FRIDAY S5 Service to Kirkby Stephen and Kendal run by Western Dales Bus continues as before.

FULL TIMETABLES FOR EACH DAY FOLLOW BELOW AND ON SUBSEQUENT PAGES

S1 MONDAY

S1 FRIDAY

Kendal Blackhall Road to Sedbergh Maryfell via Oxenholme and return

From 31st March 2025

	Mon&Fri	Mon&Fri	Mon&Fri
Kendal Blackhall Road	9:40	11:11	13:26
Kendal K Village	9:45	11:16	13:31
Oxenholme Station	9:50	11:21	13:36
Killington M6 bridge	10:00	11:31	13:46
Sedbergh Spar	10:09	11:40	13:55
Sedbergh Opp. Library	10:10	11:41	13:56
Sedbergh Maryfell	10:12	11:43	13:58
	..	..	..
Sedbergh Maryfell	10:18	11:53	14:05
Sedbergh Library	10:20	11:55	14:07
Sedbergh Opp. Morphets	10:21	11:56	14:08
Killington M6 bridge	10:30	12:05	14:17
Oxenholme Station	10:40	12:15	14:27
Kendal K Village	10:45	12:20	14:32
Kendal Bus Station	10:51	12:26	14:38

BUS SERVICES

S1 TUESDAY AND THURSDAY

Kirkby Stephen Co Op to Kendal Morrisons via Sedbergh and Oxenholme, and return
From 31st March 2025

	Tues&Thurs	Tues&Thurs	Tues&Thurs	Tues&Thurs
Kendal Morrisons	*	11:06	13:21	15:50
Kendal Blackhall Road	*	11:11	13:26	15:55
Kendal K Village	*	11:16	13:31	16:00
Oxenholme Station	*	11:21	13:36	16:05
Killington M6 bridge	*	11:31	13:46	16:15
Sedbergh Spar	9:11	11:40	13:55	16:24
Sedbergh Opp. Library	9:12	11:41	13:56	16:25
Sedbergh Maryfell	9:14	11:43	13:58	16:27
Cautley, Cross Keys	9:21	*	14:05	*
Fat Lamb	9:28	*	14:12	*
Kirkby Stephen Station Entrance	9:35	*	14:19	*
Kirkby Stephen Pennine Hotel	9:40	*	14:24	*
Kirkby Stephen Co-op	9:41	*	14:25	*
	..	..	..	..
Kirkby Stephen Co-op	9:51	*	14:35	*
Kirkby Stephen Social Club	9:52	*	14:36	*
Kirkby Stephen Station Entrance	9:57	*	14:41	*
Fat Lamb	10:04	*	14:48	*
Cautley, Cross Keys	10:11	*	14:55	*
Sedbergh Maryfell	10:18	11:53	15:02	*
Sedbergh Library	10:20	11:55	15:04	*
Sedbergh Opp. Morphets	10:21	11:56	15:05	*
Killington M6 bridge	10:30	12:05	15:14	*
Oxenholme Station	10:40	12:15	15:24	*
Kendal K Village	10:45	12:20	15:29	*
Kendal Bus Station	10:51	12:26	15:35	*
Kendal Morrisons	10:56	12:31	15:40	*

BUS SERVICES

S1 WEDNESDAY

Dent Village to Kendal Morrisons via Sedbergh and Oxenholme and return

From 31st March 2025

	Weds	Weds	Weds	Weds
Kendal Morrisons	*	11:06	13:21	15:50
Kendal Blackhall Road	*	11:11	13:26	15:55
Kendal K Village	*	11:16	13:31	16:00
Oxenholme Station	*	11:21	13:36	16:05
Killington M6 bridge	*	11:31	13:46	16:15
Sedbergh Spar	9:35	11:40	13:55	16:24
Sedbergh Opp. Library	9:36	11:41	13:56	16:25
Sedbergh Maryfell	9:38	11:43	13:58	16:27
Dent Village	9:53	*	14:13	*
	..	..	..	..
Dent Village	10:03	*	14:47	*
Sedbergh Maryfell	10:18	11:53	15:02	*
Sedbergh Library	10:20	11:55	15:04	*
Sedbergh Opp. Morphets	10:21	11:56	15:05	*
Killington M6 bridge	10:30	12:05	15:14	*
Oxenholme Station	10:40	12:15	15:24	*
Kendal K Village	10:45	12:20	15:29	*
Kendal Bus Station	10:51	12:26	15:35	*
Kendal Morrisons	10:56	12:31	15:40	*

LOOKAROUND EDITORIAL TEAM

Myles Ripley (T)	Team Leader and Chairman	Mark Crawford	Proofreading
TBA	Treasurer	Jane Fisher (T)	Proofreading
Philip Johns (T)	Secretary	Paul Shepard	Proofreading
Karen Bruce Lockhart	Proofreading	Ed Welti (T)	Compilation and Vice Chairman
Trish Cooling	Proofreading	Valerie Welti (T)	Advertising Administration
		Ellen Morrison	Advertising

Editorial Team members annotated with (T) are also Trustees.

Jackie Whicker is Life Time President but is no longer involved in compilation

BUS SERVICES

Western Dales Bus

**S5 Fridays - Kirkby Stephen Shopper
Sedbergh - Kirkby Stephen - Ravenstonedale -
Newbiggin - Kendal Bus Station - Kendal Morrisons**

From 31st March 2025

Sedbergh Dalesman	0900	..	..
Cautley Cross Keys	0909	..	..
Kirkby Stephen Station entrance	0923	..	..
Kirkby Stephen, Market Square	0928	..	..
Kirkby Stephen Co-op	0935	1139	1428
Kirkby Stephen Social Club	0936	1140	1429
Kirkby Stephen Station entrance	0941	1145	1434
<i>Trains to Carlisle</i>	0934	1106	1501
<i>Trains to Leeds</i>	0920	1146	1455
Ravenstonedale Kings Head	0947	1151	1440
Newbiggin on Lune	0950	1254	1443
Tebay Roundabout	0958	1202	1451
Killington M6 bridge	1008	1212	1501
Kendal Castle Green	1017	1221	1510
Kendal Bus Station	1022	1226	1515
Kendal Morrisons	1027	1231	1520
Kendal Morrisons	1037	1326	1530
Kendal Blackhall Road	1042	1331	1535
Kendal Castle Green	1047	1336	1540
Killington M6 Bridge	1056	1345	1549
Tebay Roundabout	1106	1355	1659
Newbiggin on Lune	1114	1403	1607
Ravenstonedale Kings Head	1117	1406	1610
Kirkby Stephen Station entrance	1123	1412	1616
<i>Trains to Carlisle</i>	1106	1501	1703
<i>Trains to Leeds</i>	1146	1455	1717
Kirkby Stephen Pennine Hotel	1128	1417	1621
Kirkby Stephen Co-op	1129	1418	1623
Kirkby Stephen Market Street	..	..	1624
Kirkby Stephen Station entrance	..	..	1629
Cautley Cross Keys	..	..	1643
Sedbergh, Library	..	..	1652

BUS SERVICES

S1 SATURDAY

Dent Station to Kendal Morrisons via Sedbergh and Oxenholme and return

From 31st March 2025

	Sat	Sat	Sat	Sat	Sat
Dent Station	*	10:53	*	*	17:37
Dent Village	*	11:08	*	15:05	17:52
Sedbergh Maryfell	8:35	11:23	13:15	15:20	18:07
Sedbergh Library	8:37	11:25	13:17	15:22	18:09
Sedbergh Opp. Morphets	8:38	11:26	13:18	15:23	*
Killington M6 bridge	8:47	11:35	13:27	15:32	*
Oxenholme Station	8:57	11:45	13:37	15:42	*
Kendal K Village	9:02	11:50	13:42	15:47	*
Kendal Bus Station	9:08	11:56	13:48	15:53	*
Kendal Morrisons	9:13	12:01	13:53	15:58	*
	..	..	..	..	..
Kendal Morrisons	9:23	12:23	14:03	16:08	*
Kendal Blackhall Road	9:28	12:28	14:08	16:13	*
Kendal K Village	9:33	12:33	14:13	16:18	*
Oxenholme Station	9:38	12:38	14:18	16:23	*
Killington M6 bridge	9:43	12:43	14:23	16:28	*
Sedbergh Spar	9:57	12:57	14:37	16:42	*
Sedbergh Opp. Library	9:58	12:58	14:38	16:43	*
Sedbergh Maryfell	10:00	13:00	14:40	16:45	*
Dent Village	10:15	*	14:55	17:00	*
Dent Station	10:30	*	*	17:15	*

DENT RAILWAY STATION TIMETABLE

Valid from June 2024

(N) Through train to Leeds, Sheffield and Nottingham

(S) Originates in Sheffield (G) Time at Garsdale - DOES NOT STOP at Dent.

Cancellations are always possible, so please check before travelling:

National Rail Enquiries (03457 484950), or Northern (0800 200 60 60)

Northbound to Carlisle For Garsdale times, add 5 minutes			Southbound to Leeds For Garsdale times, subtract 5 minutes		
Mon-Fri	Sat	Sun	Mon-Fri	Sat	Sun
06.49	07.55	10.46	07.03	09.08	10.40
09.16	09.16	12.39 (S)	09.38	10.42	13.38
10.47	10.47	14.01	12.12	12.12	16.35 (N)
12.17	12.17	15.53	14.40 (G)	14.40 (G)	18.40
14.45	14.45	17.48	16.05	16.05	20.26
16.46	16.46	20.20	17.33	17.33	..
18.15	18.15	..	19.38	19.38	..
19.45	19.45	..	21.22 (G)	21.22 (G)	..

Religious Services in Sedbergh

CHURCH OF ENGLAND

The Benefice of the Western Dales

**Vicar: Rev'd Andy Burgess
20018**

andy.burgess@westerndales.org.uk

Licensed clergy:

Rev'd Christine Brown 25418

Rev'd Lindsay Gray

Churchwardens:

St Andrew's, Sedbergh

Tony Reed Screen 21081

Susan Sharrocks 20754

churchwardens.sedbergh@westerndales.org.uk

St Andrew's, Dent

Rev'd Andy Burgess

andy.burgess@westerndales.org.uk

St John the Baptist's, Garsdale

Bill Mawdsley and Rosemary Lord

churchwardens.garsdale@westerndales.org.uk

St Mark's, Cautley

Judith Bush and Maureen Hinch

churchwardens.cautley@westerndales.org.uk

St John the Evangelist's, Cowgill

Janice Moorby and Heather Fraser

churchwardens.cowgill@westerndales.org.uk

Holy Trinity, Howgill

Helen Hoggarth

churchwardens.howgill@westerndales.org.uk

St John the Evangelist's, Firbank

**Currently no churchwardens,
please contact Sedbergh
churchwardens**

All Saints', Killington

Neil Brocklehurst 07801 940548

ROMAN CATHOLIC

St. Andrew's Parish Church

Sunday 12.00

Parish Priest Kendal

Tel: 015397 20063

SOCIETY OF FRIENDS - QUAKERS

Brigflatts

Sunday 10.30

Janet Chetwood (Comms Clerk)

Tel: 21715

Sally Ingham (Business Clerk)

Tel: 07939 569559

DENTDALE

CHRISTIAN FELLOWSHIP

Rhumes, Dent LA10 5QJ

Sarah Woof Tel: 25212

METHODIST CHURCH IN THE WESTERN DALES

Cornerstone Community Church, New
Street, Sedbergh;

Dent; Garsdale Low Smithy; Hawes
Junction

Rev'd Andy Burgess 20018

andy.burgess@westerndales.org.uk

UNITARIAN & FREE CHRISTIAN CHAPEL

Market Place, Kendal

Sunday 11.00

**Amanda Reynolds Tel: 07545
375721**

Anglican Service Times

ST ANDREW'S CHURCH, SEDBERGH

Every Sunday	8.30am, BCP Holy Communion 10.30am, Holy Communion
4th Sunday	4.00pm Teatime Church
Mondays	9.30am, Morning Prayer
Wednesdays	11.30am, BCP Holy Communion

ST ANDREW'S CHURCH, DENT

2nd and 4th Sunday	10.30am, Holy Communion
Tuesdays	9.30am, Morning Prayer

ST MARK'S CHURCH, CAUTLEY

3rd Sunday	9.30am, Morning Prayer + HC (ext)
5th Sunday	2.30pm, Taizé Service

ST JOHN THE BAPTIST'S CHURCH, GARSDALE

1st Sunday	10.00am, Holy Communion
3rd Sunday	10.00am, Morning Prayer
5th Sunday	10.00am, Morning Prayer

ST JOHN THE EVANGELIST'S CHURCH, COWGILL

1st Sunday	2.30pm, Evening Prayer
3rd Sunday	2.30pm, Holy Communion

HOLY TRINITY CHURCH, HOWGILL

2nd Sunday	9.30am, Holy Communion
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ST JOHN THE EVANGELIST'S CHURCH, FIRBANK

2nd Sunday	2.30pm, Holy Communion
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ALL SAINTS' CHURCH, KILLINGTON

1st Sunday	2.30pm, Afternoon Service
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Methodist Service Times

CORNERSTONE - Sunday 10.30am
DENTDALE - 1st and 3rd Sunday 10.30pm
GARSDALE - 2nd and 4th Sunday 2pm.

*Combined plans for Western Dales Mission Community
December 2025*

	Time	7th	14th	21st	24th	25th	28th
St. Andrew's, Sedbergh LA10 5BZ	8am	HC-BCP	HC-BCP	HC-BCP			HC-BCP
	10.30am	Morning Service	HC	6.00pm Town Carol Service	4.30pm Nativity Play with Carols 11.30pm Christmas Night Holy Communion	10.30am Christmas Day HC Service	Morning Service
Cornerstone Community Church, Sedbergh LA10 5AF	10.30am	Connect service	Service 4pm- Messy Church	Joint HC Service	6pm Christingle	Christmas Day Service	Morning Service
St. Mark's, Cautley LA10 5LZ	2.30pm			Carol Service		9.30am-Christmas Day HCx Service	
St. John's, Garsdale LA10	10am	HC		Morning Service			
Garsdale Low Smithy Methodist Chapel LA10 5PF	2.00pm					10.00am Christmas Day Service	Service
Hawes Junction Methodist Chapel, Garsdale Head, LA10 5PT	2.30pm		Carol Service				
All Saints, Killington LA6 2HA	2.30 pm	Afternoon Service			2.30pm Carol Service		
Holy Trinity Howgill LA10 5JD	9.30am		6.00pm Carol Service				
St. John's Firbank LA10 5EF	2.30pm		HC (19 th - 7pm Carol Service)				
St. Andrew's, Dent LA10 5QL	10.30am		HC (15 th - 7pm Carol Service)		4.30pm Blessing of the Crib	10.30am Christmas Day HC Service	HC
St. John's, Cowgill LA10 5RJ	2.30pm	Afternoon Service	(18 th - 7pm Carol Service)	HC	7.00pm Carols by Lantern	9.00am Christmas Day HC Service	
Dentdale Methodist Chapel LA10 5QJ	10.30am	Service		All Age Service			
Quakers, Friends Meeting House, Brigflatts Lane, LA10 5HN	10.30am	Meeting for Worship.	Meeting for Worship OR Area Meeting Zoom Worship.	Meeting for Worship.			Meeting for Worship.
Roman Catholics, St. Andrew's, Sedbergh LA10 5BZ	12 noon	Service	Service	Service	6.30pm Christmas Mass		
	Tues	2nd					
St. Andrew's, Dent, LA10 5QL	9.30am	HC-BCP					
	Weds	3rd	10th	17th			31st
St. Andrew's, Sedbergh LA10 5BZ	11.30am	HC-BCP	HC-BCP	HC-BCP			
Roman Catholics	21.00						Compline Night Prayer
	Thurs		11th				
Quakers	19:30		Meeting for Worship (venue tbc)				
HC- Holy Communion (HCx- Extended Communion)				BCP- Book of Common Prayer			

Combined plans for Western Dales Mission Community
January 2026

	Time	4 th	11 th	18 th	25 th
St. Andrew's, Sedbergh LA10 5BZ	8.30am	HC-BCP	HC-BCP	HC-BCP	HC-BCP
	10.30am	Epiphany Service with HC	HC	Joint Service	HC 4pm Teatime Church Service
Cornerstone Community Church, Sedbergh LA10 5AF	10.30am	Connect	Covenant Service with HC 4pm- Messy Church		
St. Mark's, Cautley LA10 5LZ	9.30am			HC	
St. John's, Garsdale LA10	10am	HC		Morning Service	
Garsdale Low Smithy Methodist Chapel LA10 5PF	2.00pm		Covenant Service with HC		Service
All Saints, Killington LA6 2HA	2.30pm	Afternoon Service			
Holy Trinity Howgill LA10 5JD	9.30am		HCx		
St. John's Firbank LA10 5EF	2.30pm		Afternoon Service		
St. Andrew's, Dent LA10 5QL	10.30am		HC		All-Age Service
Dentdale Methodist Chapel LA10 5QJ	10.30am	Service		Covenant Service with HC	
St. John's, Cowgill LA10 5RJ	2.30pm	Afternoon Service		HC	
Quakers, Friends Meet- ing House, Brigflatts Lane, LA10 5HN	10.30am	Meeting for Worship	Meeting for Worship OR Area Meeting Zoom Worship. Contact below.	Meeting for Worship	Meeting for Worship
Roman Catholics, St. Andrew's, Sedbergh LA10 5BZ	12 noon	Service	Service	Service	Service
	Tuesday	6th	13th	20th	27th
St. Andrew's, Dent LA10 5QL	9.30am	HC-BCP		HC-BCP	
	Wednes- day	7th	14th	21st	28th
St. Andrew's, Sedbergh LA10 5BZ	11.30am	HC-BCP	HC-BCP	HC-BCP	HC-BCP
Roman Catholics	21.00				Compline Night Prayer
	Thursday		8th	22nd	
Quakers	19:30		Meeting for Worship (venue tbc)	Meeting for Worship (venue tbc)	
HC- Holy Communion (HCx- Holy Communion by Extension) BCP- Book of Common Prayer			MP- Morning Prayer		

Quakers contact Pam Coren 015396 22586;
Sedbergh Roman Catholics contact Father Hugh Pollock 015397 20063

PUBLIC INFORMATION

Sedbergh Medical Practice

01539 718191

When we are closed please ring
111 or 999 if appropriate

Option 1 - 24hr Prescription line

Surgery and Dispensary Opening Hours

Monday – Friday 8am – 6.30pm
(Doors open at 8.15am)

Doctors Clinics

Monday – Friday

Open Surgery – 8.30am – 10am
(Face to face appointments – please phone on the day to book an appointment)
Telephone Triage – 10.30am – 12pm
(please phone or book online)
Late Morning Appointments 10.30am – 12pm &
Afternoon appointments 2.30pm-6pm
(please phone or book online)

Please do not attend if you have any symptoms of Covid-19 (or if you have had a recent positive test)

Practice Nurse/Health Care Assistant clinics

Available to book online or call reception to book

Saturday morning clinics

Are now available, see our website for details and call reception to book

For more information on all clinic times please see our website

www.sedberghmp.nhs.uk
for further details.

Location of Public Defibrillators

72 Main Street
People's Hall, Howgill Lane
Fire Station, Long Lane
Health Centre, Station Road
Telephone Box, Millthorpe
Dent Village Car Park (opp Memorial Hall)
Access Codes to the Defibs are supplied on contacting Ambulance Control on 999

First Responders IN EMERGENCIES CONTACT THE EMERGENCY SERVICES

The numbers below are for information on volunteering only

Sedbergh - Myles Ripley 07779 367855
Dent - Wendy Pontefract 015396 25253

POLICE

101 or 999

Email: 101@cumbria.police.uk

Crimestoppers 0800 555 111

Community Officers

Mandy Colman - 07773 181425

Amanda.coleman@cumbria.police.uk

Adam Roberts—07773 217740

adam.roberts2@cumbria.police.uk

DENTAL SURGERY

Main Street 015396 20626

Ben Houghton (principal), Miss Katie McKay,
Emma Fairley, Amelia Dore, Daisy Coupe,
Ella Capstick, Therapist/hygienist.

Monday to Friday 0900 - 1700

SEDBERGH LIBRARY Main Street

01539 713150

https://www.cumbria.gov.uk/libraries/locations/sed_lib.asp

Wednesday 1000 - 1230 1400 - 1700

Friday 1300 - 1700

Saturday 1000 - 1400

DENT LIBRARY Main Street 01539 713520

Tuesday 0900 - 1900

Saturday 0900 - 1400

SEDBERGH & DISTRICT INFORMATION CENTRE

for resident & visitor information

72 Main Street, Sedbergh

Open seven days a week 1000 - 1600

e-mail: tic@sedbergh.org.uk

Tel: 015396 20125

www.sedbergh.org.uk

If you are an event organiser or accommodation provider and you would like a listing on the website, or if you are a local organisation and want the website to carry information about your activities, please email the Information and Book Centre on office@sedbergh.org.uk."

VETERINARY SURGERY

14 Long Lane

015396 20335 (including emergencies)

FarmGate Vets

Office Hours Monday-Friday 0830 - 1700

Companion Animal Consultations 0900 - 1000 *

Monday-Friday Appointment Only 1400 - 1500 *

PUBLIC TOILETS

Main Street, Sedbergh

Main Street, Dent

POST OFFICE

Spar, Station Road, LA10 5DL

MARKET DAY

Wednesday

Last Page Update:

December 2025